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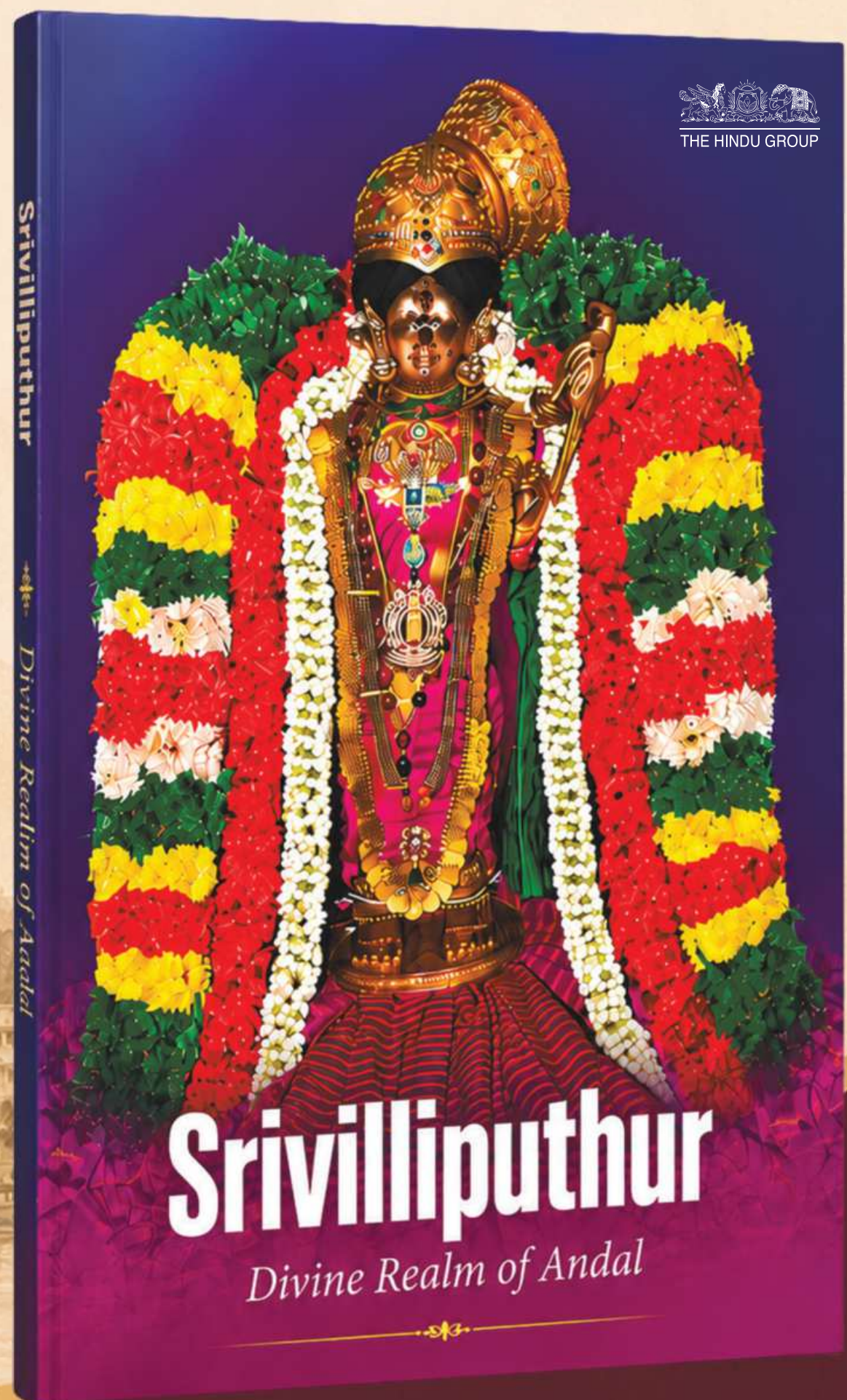
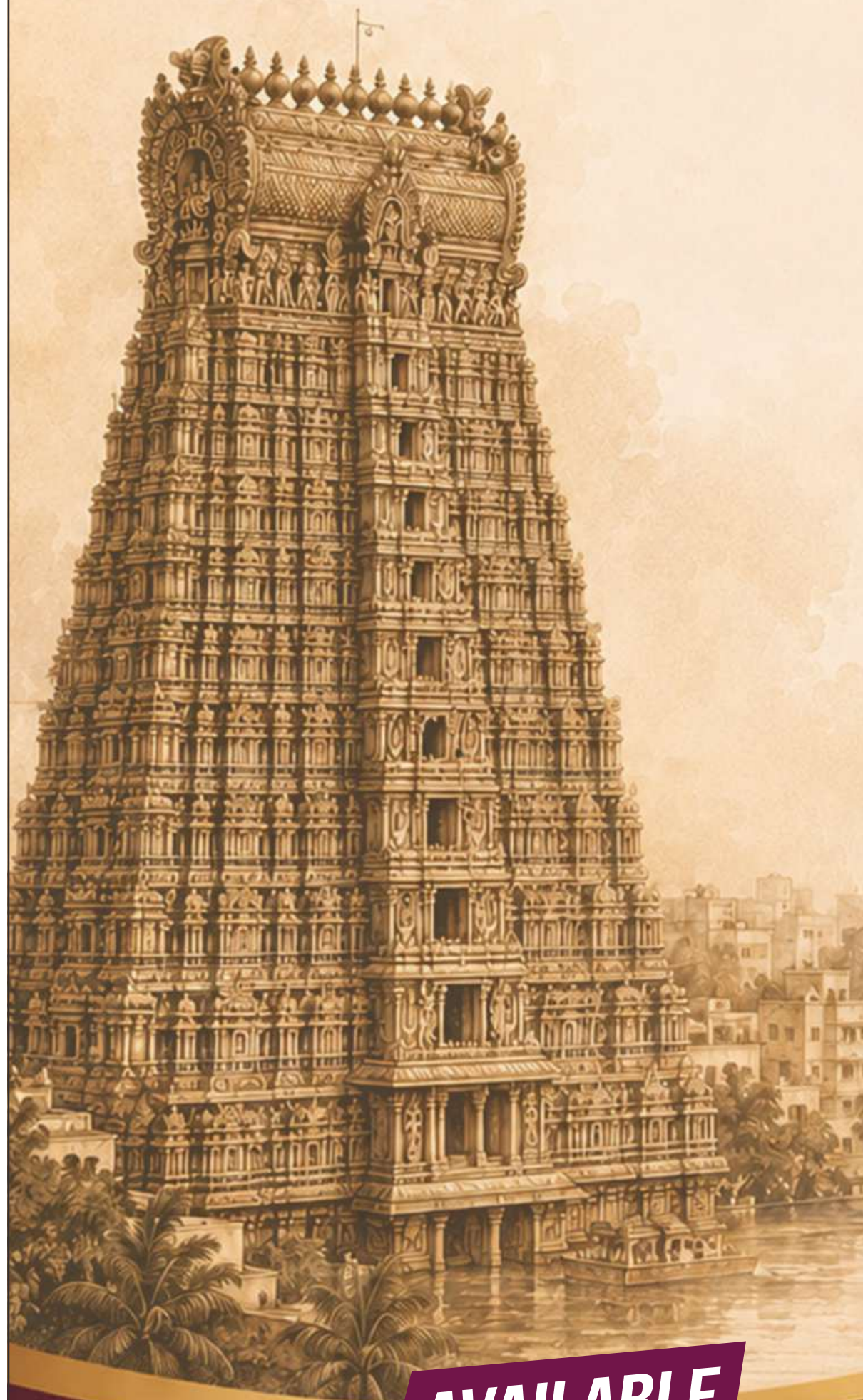
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From Page One

Girl killed after SUV rams two-wheeler

At first, the police arrested two persons: N. Balaguru of Ekattuthangal and M. Kishore Kumar of Nerkundram. After interrogating them, the police picked up A. Suman Sakthivel of Virugambakkam, Mohan, and Muthukannan. They are now looking for the sixth person. Suman Sakthivel was driving the SUV that hit the two-wheeler, the police officer said. The Koyambedu police are also investigating how the minor girl was allowed into the bar. In a late-night operation on Sunday, the Prohibition and Excise officials sealed the bar.

INBRIEF



Vasan urges Union, State govt. to act against use of tobacco

On the occasion of the World No Tobacco Day, Tamil Maanila Congress (Moopanar) leader G.K. Vasana, on Sunday, urged the Central and State governments to act against the use of tobacco by organising awareness programmes to sensitise the public to its ill-effects. Citing reports, the former Union Minister said that about 60 lakh people were losing their lives across the world annually from tobacco use. Referring to a study, Mr. Vasana said that about 13 lakh people in India were affected by tobacco annually. The sale of tobacco encouraged the habit of smoking, and this affected people of all age groups, Mr. Vasana added. He further called upon the public to discourage the use of tobacco among their family members.

Probe into ‘harassment’ of head constable launched

An inquiry has been initiated into the alleged sexual harassment of a woman head constable, now a part of the Singappen Special Task Force (SSTF), by a police officer attached to the Arumuganeri police station in Thoothukudi district. According to sources, the woman constable joined the SSTF on May 28. She was allegedly subjected to sexual harassment through messages on social media during her tenure at the Arumuganeri police station. Although no formal complaint has been received from her, an inquiry has been initiated based on the information received. “Appropriate action will be taken based on the findings of the inquiry,” a senior police officer said.

AIADMK voices concern over Aadhav Arjuna holding 2 posts

AIADMK Rajya Sabha Member I.S. Inbadurai on Sunday voiced concern over Minister for Sports Development Aadhav Arjuna holding two posts – one as a regulator and the other as an administrator – at the same time. In a social media post, Mr. Inbadurai pointed out that Mr. Arjuna still holds the post of president of the Basketball Federation of India. “This raises serious concern about a potential conflict of interest and undermines public confidence in impartial sports governance,” Mr. Inbadurai said. “For governance to be fair, it is not enough that there is no bias; there must also be no appearance of bias,” he added.

T.N. government announces zero-tolerance approach towards delays in granting approval for building plan

S. Vijay Kumar
CHENNAI

To prevent corrupt practices and ease the process of granting building plan approvals, the Tamil Nadu government has announced a zero-tolerance approach to delays. Warning Town Planning Officers of disciplinary action in case of any administrative negligence, manual intervention or failure in enforcing online processes while granting building plan approvals, P. Madhusudan Reddy, Director of Municipal Administration, said clearances must be executed within the stipulated statutory timelines.



Director of Municipal Administration says failure to enforce online transparency protocols will lead to disciplinary action. FILE PHOTO

“All fee related to approval must be accepted through online payment modules only. Applicants, architects, or structural engineers or any third person are not required to appear

Body of woman found in car at workshop in Madurai

The Hindu Bureau
MADURAI

The highly decomposed body of an unidentified woman was found in a car at a workshop in Madurai on Saturday night.

A case of suspicious death has been registered. The body was taken to the Government Rajaji Hospital for a post-mortem.

The police said the car belonged to a man from Ramanathapuram, who had left it at the workshop in Venkatachalapuram under the Subramaniyapuram police station limits on May 21, as the second-hand vehicle required repairs.

The police were alerted on Saturday night after a foul smell emanated from the car. On opening the door of the car, which was not locked, the police found the body on the rear seat. Forensic experts inspected the vehicle.

The doors of all the cars at the workshop were left unlocked.

The police suspect that the deceased was a mentally unsound woman. They are verifying whether the profiles of missing women matched with that of the deceased.

“Since the body is in a highly decomposed state, only the post-mortem report can reveal the cause of death,” the police said.

White Paper on State govt.’s finances getting finalised

While assuming office last month, CM Vijay said his govt. would release the document, alleging that the DMK govt. left behind an empty treasury. It is likely to be out in a few days, says an official

T. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

A White Paper on the Tamil Nadu government’s finances is getting the finishing touches. “The document is likely to be ready in a few days,” says a senior official.

When he assumed office last month, Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay announced that his government would come out with a White Paper. He claimed the previous DMK government had left behind “an empty treasury”.

In fact, on Saturday, Finance Minister N. Marie Wilson said in Nagapattinam that it would take two weeks for the document to be finalised.

Now, the government is planning to present the White Paper in the Assembly, just as the AIADMK government did in August 2001. At that time, Finance Minister C. Ponnaian presented a White Paper as a part of his Budget speech for 2001-02. However, 20 years later, before presenting the Budget to the Assembly, the DMK government released a similar document at a press conference addressed by the then Finance Minister, Palanivel Thiaga Rajan.

Given the tight financial



Financial crunch: It is estimated that over ₹1 lakh crore a year would be required to fully implement around a dozen promises, including the free bus travel for women across the State. FILE PHOTO

position of the government, several election promises of the TVK will likely remain only on paper.

According to a conservative estimate, it would require over ₹1 lakh crore a year to fully implement around a dozen promises, including the increase in the monthly assistance for women from ₹1,000 to ₹2,500, free bus travel for women across the State, six free refills of cooking gas cylinders, one-sovereign gold coins for eligible women at the time of marriage, gold rings for children who are born in government hospitals, ₹3,000 in old age pension, and the grant of ₹15,000 a year to parents or guardians of school-going children (up to Class 12).

The government has on-

ly implemented the diluted versions of the promises of 200 units of free electricity every month for the domestic category and a full waiver of crop loans taken by small and marginal farmers from cooperative societies along with a 50% waiver for big farmers.

Though the free electricity for domestic consumers has not triggered any adverse response, the decision on the crop loan waiver is being criticised by different parties, including the allies of the ruling TVK and farmers’ bodies.

The government has not yet spelt out how it is going to implement the increase in the monthly assistance for women, as the annual burden will be approximately ₹39,000 crore, even if it chooses to cover

Palaniswami did not build a strong alliance to garner anti-incumbency votes, says PT chief K. Krishnasamy

Udhav Naig
CHENNAI

The fractured mandate in the recent State Assembly election could have been avoided had the AIADMK, led by Edappadi K. Palaniswami, been accommodative towards its alliance partners and built a strong coalition that could pull in the anti-incumbency votes, Puthiya Tamilagam (PT) founder K. Krishnasamy said on Friday.

Speaking at The Hindu office in Chennai, Dr. Krishnasamy said that though the DMK had delivered on its promises such as the *Kalaigarnar Magalir Urimai Thittam*, people felt that it had failed to provide good governance, resulting in severe anti-incumbency.

“More than the economic schemes, people felt that the DMK government had failed to deliver good governance. The anti-incumbency should have helped

the AIADMK, but they did not build an alliance good enough to garner those votes. EPS and the BJP made mistakes. The alliance failed to build a narrative on why it was the viable alternative while EPS kept sending the alliance partners out. So, people preferred the third option. How long can people put up with intra-party issues (between O. Panneerselvam and EPS) of the AIADMK?” he said.

Dr. Krishnasamy said other political parties, over the last few decades, had been preparing the people for an alternative to the two major Dravidian parties – the DMK and the AIADMK – but it was Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay’s TVK which managed to channel that sentiment.

“Many political parties have tried to form a third front to defeat both these parties – communists tried it in the 1996 Lok Sabha election, Moopanar (G.K.



Had the Dravidian parties promised their allies a share in power, the results would have been much different, says Krishnasamy

Moopanar’s Tamil Maanila Congress) and Puthiya Tamilagam in 1999, some parties in 2016, as well as Vijayakant, Sarath Kumar, and Bhagyaraj, all tried in their own way. In Tamil Nadu, the sentiment (among the people) for an alternative to these two Dravidian parties has been simmering. The TVK, led by Vijay, gave hope and shape to this expectation and channelled this sentiment. PT has consistently stated that

there should not be a “one-party” rule – that both the DMK and the AIADMK must change and include other parties in the Cabinet. Times have changed. Vijay identified this sentiment and announced it in the party’s first public rally,” he said.

Dr. Krishnasamy further said though he had sensed that no party would secure a majority in the 2026 Assembly election, he believed that the DMK would

emerge as the single largest party. “I said so in one of the press meets in Coimbatore. I believed that, since the DMK was the ruling party and had a settled alliance, they would win more seats (than other parties). Had the Dravidian parties promised their allies a share in power, the results would have been much different,” he said.

He added that the established Dravidian parties, the DMK in particular, should have sensed the shifts happening on the ground. “The established political parties did not expect this result, but they should have sensed it... because they had all the modern systems to sense it. But, they continued with old traditions.”

Asked whether the inclusion of eight Scheduled Caste MLAs in the Cabinet could be seen as a historic moment for social justice in the State, Dr. Krishnasamy said the development

Vanathi Srinivasan criticises govt. over law and order situation

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

BJP leader Vanathi Srinivasan on Sunday criticised the Tamil Nadu government over various incidents in the State and for its alleged failure to maintain law and order.

Merely transferring officials without any concrete step to ensure the safety of women and maintain law and order was of no use, she said.

Drug-related incidents

Ms. Srinivasan referred to an incident in which a young woman was murdered after being run over by a car and an act of vandalism in Thoothukudi district under the influence of ganja and alcohol. The rampant use of alcohol and other psychotropic substances had left the State worried about the loss of human lives, she said.

The previous DMK government had failed to control the movement of psychotropic substances and several youths became addicts, Ms. Srinivasan said, adding that the trend continued under the TVK-led government too.

Reports of murders and other offences every other day only showed how law and order was being maintained in the State, she said.

4 convicts booked for attacking accused in rape and murder case

The Hindu Bureau
COIMBATORE

The Race Course police formally recorded the arrests of four convicts on the charge of attacking K. Karthi – the main accused in the sexual assault-cum-murder of a 10-year-old girl near Sultur – during a scuffle at the Coimbatore Central Prison on Saturday.

The police said the four persons were booked for assault based on a complaint lodged by a prison officer.

Since they were serving their sentence in prison, the police recorded their formal arrests there by following due procedure with

They, along with another prisoner, have been shifted to prisons in Chennai, Vellore, Cuddalore, Tiruchi and Salem

the jurisdictional magistrate, Race Course Inspector G. Jeyachandran said.

Police sources said the incident took place at the hospital on the prison campus, where Karthi, 35, was recovering from the fractures he suffered while allegedly attempting to escape from the police on May 22.

The four convicts assaulted him with objects

such as pen, spoon, and plate, the police said.

Prison staff immediately intervened and shifted him to the prisoner’s ward at the Coimbatore Medical College Hospital, where he had undergone treatment till May 28.

The four prisoners arrested in the assault and another prisoner were shifted to prisons in Chennai, Vellore, Salem, Tiruchi and Cuddalore.

Prison sources said a detailed probe was being conducted under prison Superintendent Senthil Kumar. Prison sources claimed that the injuries Karthi suffered in the assault were not grievous.

INBRIEF



Walkathon conducted to mark World No Tobacco Day

The GRT Hotels and Resorts conducted a walkathon to mark World No Tobacco Day. According to a press release, the World No Tobacco Day Walkathon 2026 saw a unified, synchronised turnout across its portfolio of 22 hotels, spanning five States, all of which are 100% smoke-free. Close to 1500 participants – including hotel guests, staff members, families, and local community members – walked three km to advocate for a smoke-free, tobacco-free future.

Text & Context and Science

Weekday features on *The Hindu* epaper (epaper.thehindu.com) carry explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (June 1, Monday), the following articles are available:

■ A revival of sedition tied to consent
[newsth.live/revivalofsedition](#)

■ The apex court rings its own chain
[newsth.live/apexcourt](#)

You can use your smartphone's inbuilt features to access these articles. If it's an Android phone, use Google Lens to read and tap the url to access an article. If it's an iPhone, use Live Text on camera to do the same.

Chennai Port to get its first battery-operated tugboat in 2028

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chennai Port will get its first battery-operated green tug in two years, a move to shift away from the conventional diesel-powered tugs, thereby cutting greenhouse gas emissions.

Officials said the high-powered specialised vessels – harbour tugs in ports

– aid in a host of operations ranging from helping pilots with docking, undocking, towing huge ships, and various other auxiliary services. Chennai Port, which is now equipped with three diesel-powered tugs, will have the battery-operated fourth one by 2028.

The push to procure such tugs and switch to greener alternatives came



Sources say the contract will be awarded to the lowest bidder soon. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

when the Ministry of Port, Shipping, and Waterways launched the Green Tug

Transition Program (GTTP) two years back. This initiative comes as part of Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047, wherein the goal is that, by 2030, the carbon emissions from port vessels have to come down by 30 per cent.

The Ministry plans to change all the tugs operating in major ports across the country to green tugs to bring in an eco-friendly

fleet by the end of 2040. This project will be carried out in five phases.

Some of the major ports, including Chennai, have already commenced the work to procure these tugs.

Chennai Port Authority had floated bids by the end of 2025, and sources said the lowest bidder has emerged and the contract will be awarded shortly.

The first battery-operated tug with a 60-tonne capacity will be delivered to the port in two years.

The firm will be responsible for manning, operating, maintaining, and managing the tug for a period of 15 years. The tug may also be engaged for berthing, unberthing, or serve as a standby as fire float, oil dispersant spraying boat as well, officials added.

Federation urges State government to conduct Special TET without delay

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu Graduate Teachers Federation (TNGTF) has urged the State government to conduct the Special Teacher Eligibility Test (TET) for in-service teachers without delay.

The Supreme Court had recently given teachers in-service an extension of one year to clear the TET, moving the deadline from August 31, 2027, to August 31, 2028, taking into consideration the importance of ensuring continuity in elementary education.

Exam on July 4

The Tamil Nadu government has scheduled the exams for July 4. According to a statement from the association, “Teacher vacancies should be filled from the beginning of the academic year when schools re-opens. The educational welfare of the students should not be affected due to delays in promotions or new appointments.”

General secretary of the association P. Patrick Raymond said quality training, online classes, sample question papers, subject-wise guidelines should be provided through SCERT and DIET so that teachers can face the exam.

“The Tamil Nadu government should immediately take legal and administrative security measures to ensure that the job security and promotion rights of senior teachers who have served for many years are not affected,” he added.

In this regard, the association urged the government to announce an action plan to protect both teachers and students, taking into account the practical implications of the Supreme Court’s decision.

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PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT

This is to reiterate to the public at large that with the demise of Mr. P.I. Peter, the founding partner of the Firm 'M/s. Divine Wellness Noni', on 19.11.2024 the said Firm stood dissolved with effect from 19.11.2024. The sole legal heirs of Late Mr. P.I. Peter, viz, Mr. Peter Prem Hemmi, S/o. Late Mr. P.I. Peter, and Mrs. Prea Peter, D/o. Late Mr. P.I. Peter hereby clarify and confirm that, with the dissolution of the Firm effectively from 19.11.2024, no individual/entity/company/firm/organisation is authorized to carry on any business claiming association with their father and/or in the name of the dissolved Firm. It is further clarified that the legacy of their father in the business of Noni Nutraceuticals shall be carried forward by the entity M/s. Health Care Products, d.b.a. Original Divine Noni. It is also hereby notified by the legal heirs of Late Mr. P.I. Peter that except for the entity expressly recognized and authorized above, no individual/entity/company/firm/organisation is authorised to claim any association with the legacy and goodwill of Late Mr. P.I. Peter, his business of Noni Nutraceuticals, and/or the intellectual property held by him. Any attempt on part of any individual/entity/company/ firm/organisation to use, register or otherwise exploit the name 'Divine Wellness Noni' and/or the photographs of Late Mr. P.I. Peter and/or the IP rights held by him will give rise to stringent legal action. Further, any distributor found dealing with the products/goods originating from an unauthorised business shall be liable for the legal consequences, both civil and criminal. Any distributor or wellwisher seeking further clarification on the above subject may direct their queries to the contact information furnished below, which shall serve as the sole point of communication on the said subject. Name: **Peter Prem Hemmi** E-mail address: legal@originaldivinenoni.com Issued jointly by the Legal Heirs of Late Mr. P.I. Peter Mr. Peter Prem Hemmi & Mrs. Prea Peter

Narada Gana Sabha

Ph:24997788 / 9840928049

Programmes for June 2026 - 10th - Talent Promotion Concert - Nadasangamam - Vinayak Vaidyanathan - Veena, Calcutta Venkatram (Mridangam), Karaikkal Jaikishan (Ghatam), Main Hall - 10th to 14th June 2026 - Daily at 6 pm - The 64 Art Forms in Hindu Dharma by Sri U Ve Dushyanth Sridhar. (Supported by VB) 12th - Guru Surajana-nanda day - In association with Sruthi - Laya Kendra - Carnatic Mandolin Trio - by U Nagamani, U Jaya Vigneshwar & U.Subramania Raju, B. Ganapathyraman - (Mridangam), Dr Trichy Murali (Ghatam), 20th - Natyarangam - Amit Dole (Kalakshetra) Bharathanatyam, 7.30 pm - Sayuuya Srinivasan (disciple of Divya Narada). 21st - Mangalam Muthuswamy Veena Endow-

Residents complain about rising flood risk in Velachery

Disaster management expert says the area would be flooded if the land reclamation in Kallukuttai lake by PWD is not stopped; residents' associations want the government to shelve the project

CITY MATTERS

Aloysius Xavier Lopez
CHENNAI

Residents have complained about land reclamation in the Kallukuttai lake, located near a Ramsar Site in the southern part of the city, where the Public Works Department (PWD) has been filling the area with soil.

On Sunday, residents flagged the issue on social media, pointing to the delay in stopping the work by government departments and civic agencies, including the PWD and the Greater Chennai Corporation.

Velachery resident S. Kumararaja said: “The PWD has filled soil across more than 25 acres of the waterbody, which is part of a Ramsar Site of the Pallikaranai marshland. We complained about it to the Greater Chennai Corporation a few weeks ago, and said the flood risk in Velachery would increase because of the work. Civic of-



Offering solution: Corporation officials say they will help restore the low-lying area into a proper waterbody if they receive permission from the Directorate of Technical Education, who own the land.

ficials promised that they would address the issue.”

Filled with sand

“Sand has been filled into a portion of the marshland, and the Kallukuttai waterbody is being closed by the PWD for the Dr. Ambedkar Law University. The area is located on the road connecting the Taramani MRTS road with the Velachery MRTS station,” he added.

Owing to the work, the flood risk is high in ward 177 and 178. Residents of Velachery Annai Indira Nagar Welfare Association and Federation of Velachery Welfare and Green Velachery have demanded that the State government stop the work.

N. Mathavan, a disaster management expert who was formerly with Chennai Corporation, said the work is expected to increase

flood risk in Velachery. “A government department should not do any work that increases flood risk in the city. Velachery will be flooded if the work is not stopped,” he said.

GCC officials said they were ready to help restore the low-lying area into a proper waterbody, provided they receive permission from the Directorate of Technical Education, which owns the land.



Mega blaze: Fire rages at Hyundai Mobis factory at Sriperumbudur in Kancheepuram district on Sunday. ANI VIDEO GRAB

Fire destroys two units of automobile components factory in Sriperumbudur

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A fire broke out in the industrial waste storage area of an automobile company in Sriperumbudur on Sunday and the smoke created a flutter among local residents and motorists using the Chennai-Bengaluru National Highway (NH-48).

SIPCOT complex

The Kancheepuram police said several automobile and other ancillary companies are operating in the SIPCOT industrial complex in Sriperumbudur.

The company, Hyundai Mobis, is engaged in the manufacturing of automotive spare parts, including the airbag mechanism and audio systems. Around 3.30 p.m. on Sunday, a fire broke out in the factory's waste storage area.

Aided by a gust of wind, the fire quickly spread

The fire was brought under control after more than four hours of operation

throughout the factory, with thick black smoke billowing out of the building. The company officials, after alerting the Sriperumbudur police and the fire and rescue services department, immediately evacuated all the workers from the factory to safety.

Fire tenders along with rescue personnel from both Sriperumbudur and Oragadam fire stations were despatched to the site.

Fire and Rescue Services personnel brought the fire under control after battling it for more than four hours.

Two units in the factory have been completely destroyed in the incident.

CINEMA ♦ ARTS ♦ EVENTS

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

Kartik Fine Arts
24997788 / 9840928049
Today 5.30 pm at TAG - Mylapore Fine Arts Club Auditorium Kartik Rajagopal 35th Kodai Nataka Vizha 2026. Title Sponsor: Dr. Shreevarma's PCR Maharaja Thailam. Award Distribution Function. Chief Guest, Dr. Shree Varma, CMD, Shree Varma Group of Wellness Institutions, presents the awards. Shri S.N. Srikanth, President, Kartik Fine Arts, presides. Shri P. Muthukumarar receives, Kartik Ramanujam Award of Excellence for Best Theatre artiste. Nadigar Thilagam Shri Sivaji Ganesan Award for All-round Excellence (instituted by Shri Ramkumar Ganesan) will be presented to Dummies Drama (Play: ThanimAI). 7 pm UAA presents 'Varadu Kutty' - Parikshaikku Neramachu2 by G. Radhakrishnan, Dramatisation and Direction: Y.Gee. Mahendra. All are welcome.

Kartik Fine Arts
24997788 / 9840928049
Programmes for June 2026 1st 5.30 pm at TAG Mylapore Fine Arts Club Auditorium Kartik Rajagopal 35th Kodai Nataka Vizha 2026 - Award Distribution Function 7 pm UAA presents 'Varadu Kutty' - Parikshaikku Neramachu2 by Y.Gee. Mahendra. 4th 6 pm at Narada Gana Sabha Mini Hall Bharathanatyam by K. Kaavya 7.30 pm M. Aathmika. 6th 6 pm Shravya Suresh & Adhya Narayanan 7.30 pm Padmapriya Ranganathan. 12th 7 pm at TAG Mylapore Fine Arts Club Auditorium Mali's Stage inaugurates 'Thoduvaana Manidhargal' by Kudanthai Mali. 25th 6 pm at Narada Gana Sabha Mini Hall Bharathanatyam 7.30 pm Sharmada Vishwanath. 26th 5.30 pm at Kartik Rajagopal Hall Vocal by G. K. Baanapriya 7.00 pm Hemmige S. Prashanth.

Narada Gana Sabha
Ph:24997788 / 9840928049
Programme for June 2026 - 10th - Talent Promotion Concert - Nadasangamam - Vinayak Vaidyanathan - Veena, Calcutta Venkatram (Mridangam), Karaikkal Jaikishan (Ghatam), Main Hall - 10th to 14th June 2026 - Daily at 6 pm - The 64 Art Forms in Hindu Dharma by Sri U Ve Dushyanth Sridhar. (Supported by VB) 12th - Guru Surajana-nanda day - In association with Sruthi - Laya Kendra - Carnatic Mandolin Trio - by U Nagamani, U Jaya Vigneshwar & U.Subramania Raju, B. Ganapathyraman - (Mridangam), Dr Trichy Murali (Ghatam), 20th - Natyarangam - Amit Dole (Kalakshetra) Bharathanatyam, 7.30 pm - Sayuuya Srinivasan (disciple of Divya Narada). 21st - Mangalam Muthuswamy Veena Endow-

Rasika Ranjani Sabha Foundation
Mylapore, Chennai - 600 004.
Programme for the month of **JUNE - 2026**

03-06-2026 Wednesday	10-06-2026 Thursday
5:00 PM Padmashree Srinivasan -Vocal & Party	5:00 PM Anirudh Subramanian - Vocal & Party
6:30 PM V Bharatkumar - Vocal & Party	6:30 PM Nisha Rajagopalan - Vocal & Party
09-06-2026 Friday	11-06-2026 Saturday
5:00 PM Phanya Dinesh Rudrapatnam - Vocal & Party	6:30 PM Palghat Ramprasad - Vocal & Party
10-06-2026 Wednesday	12-06-2026 Friday
5:00 PM Amrith Narayan - Vocal & Party	6:30 PM Nisha Rajagopalan - Vocal & Party
15-06-2026 Monday	19-06-2026 Friday
6:30 PM Sadguru Tyagarajar Krti-s Prasanna Venkataraman - Vocal & Party	6:30 PM Kaatrinileyy Varum Geetham by ThRee entertains.
22-06-2026 Monday	29-06-2026 Monday
6:15 PM Lec Dem by Madhusudhan Kalaiselvan & B Sargurunathan	6:30 PM
101st Birth Anniversary of R. S. Manohar, Manohar's NXGs	
Lanquantes LANKESHWARAN	
Ph. No: 86103 57987	
All Rasikas Are Welcome	

The Mylapore Fine Arts Club (Regd.) Phone: 24997755 / 42607755
Program for June 05/06/2026 Drama MAZHAIYIL ORU IRAVU by S. Anand 19.06.2026 Drama MAATHRU DEVO BHAVA by Bombay Chanakya 20/06/2026 and 21/06/2026 Bharathanatyam.

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INBRIEF



GCC Commissioner inspects Virugambakkam canal

Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) Commissioner G.S. Sameeran on Sunday inspected the stretch of Virugambakkam canal near Namachivayapuram in ward 109, where the canal joins the Cooum. The canal runs for 6.36 km from Bhuvaneshwari Nagar to the Cooum, and has a total catchment area of 30.63 sq.km. Following complaints of garbage disposal and unchecked illegal sewer connections in the canal in 2025, the GCC planned to take up a ₹30-crore project to restore it. According to a press release, the Commissioner ordered officials to desilt the waterways. The Commissioner also inspected the multi-level car parking in T. Nagar and ordered the officials to prevent unauthorised parking in the area.

2 held for throwing Molotov cocktail into vacant house

The Somangalam police arrested two persons for allegedly throwing a Molotov cocktail into a vacant house in Varadarajapuram, near Perungalathur, on Saturday. The Tambaram police said a couple, Dinesh and Divya, used to live in the house on MGR Street in Varadarajapuram. Recently, the couple had vacated the rented property and relocated to Tambaram. Late on Saturday, residents on the street saw two unidentified individuals arriving on a two-wheeler and throwing the Molotov cocktail into the house. The fire damaged a wooden door and a cot. Upon being alerted, the Somangalam police filed a case and arrested Charles, 24, and Rajkumar, 23, who were identified as Divya's relatives. During the interrogation, the police found that both Charles and Rajkumar were married to Divya's younger sisters Mahalakshmi and Sandhya, and held a grudge against Divya. Unaware that Divya had relocated, the duo threw the Molotov cocktail into the vacant house, the police added.

Outdoor workers exposed to high heat have increased risk of productivity loss: study

The study assessed 1,560 workers across 11 districts in T.N. About 88% of workers surveyed during summer were exposed to heat levels above threshold limits, compared to 42.5% during winter

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Outdoor workers exposed to high heat in Tamil Nadu were 45% more likely to report productivity losses than those working in relatively cooler conditions, according to a study that examined the impact of rising temperatures on workers in agriculture, construction, brick kilns, salt pans, and stone quarries.

The study, published in *Scientific Reports*, was conducted by Vidhya Venugopal, P.K. Latha, and Rekha Shanmugam of the Department of Environmental Health Engineering, Faculty of Public Health, Sri Ramachandra Institute of Higher Education and Research, Chennai. The researchers assessed heat exposure and productivity among workers employed in agriculture, construction, brick kilns, salt pans, and stone quarries between 2021 and 2023.

The study, which assessed 1,560 workers across 11 districts in the State, also found that nearly one in three workers reported productivity losses during summer, compared to 17% during winter.

Safety limits

Using the Wet Bulb Globe Temperature (WBGT), a widely used measure of



Summer effect: The study found that workers exposed to high heat were 1.4 times more likely to report productivity losses than those working in relatively cooler conditions. FILE PHOTO

More than 90% of workers reported symptoms such as excessive sweating, thirst, fatigue, cramps, headaches, and nausea

heat stress, the researchers found that workplace heat levels frequently exceeded recommended safety limits. Average WBGT during summer was 29.9°C, reaching up to 35°C at some sites.

About 88% of workers surveyed during summer were exposed to heat levels above threshold limits, compared to 42.5% during winter.

The study found that workers exposed to high

heat were 1.4 times more likely to report productivity losses than those working in relatively cooler conditions. Workers engaged in heavy manual labour were 1.5 times more likely to experience productivity declines.

Nearly 61% of workers who reported productivity losses did so during the summer season, compared to 39% during winter. Many said they were unable to meet daily work targets, took longer to complete tasks, or missed work because of heat-related illness, exhaustion, and fatigue.

About three-fourths of affected workers reported needing more time than usual to complete their daily workload.

Researchers also documented widespread heat-related health problems. More than 90% of workers reported symptoms such as excessive sweating, thirst, fatigue, cramps, headaches, and nausea. Workers experiencing heat-related symptoms were more than three times as likely to report productivity losses.

The study noted that districts such as Ariyalur, Chennai, and Salem recorded some of the highest heat stress levels.

Heat exposure above recommended limits was nearly ten times more likely during summer than winter.

Strained workforce

The researchers warned that rising temperatures driven by climate change could further reduce labour capacity and earnings among informal workers, who form a substantial share of the workforce. Around 15% of workers reported losing wages because of heat-related absenteeism during summer.

The study called for measures such as shaded rest areas, access to cool drinking water, scheduled breaks during peak heat hours, heat-awareness training, and stronger labour protections to safeguard outdoor workers from increasing heat stress.

People concerned over incomplete civic projects in city

Aloysius Xavier Lopez
CHENNAI

Residents have complained about incomplete civic infrastructure projects in various zones of the city.

As the next three-month period is crucial for expediting infrastructure projects ahead of the onset of the northeast monsoon, city residents have pointed to a delay in resuming work after the Assembly elections. Many of the delayed projects have not yet gained momentum even after the Model Code of Conduct was lifted on May 6.

G. Swaminathan of Madipakkam said the road relaying work in the city's southern parts had not started after the election. "Important roads such as Madipakkam Kuberan Nagar Extension 12th Street and Govindasamy Nagar Main Road have been in a bad shape for many years. Two years ago, they started digging the road to lay sewer pipelines. Then, they carried out patch work. Later, they dug up the road for water pipelines. Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) officials said they would relay the road after the monsoon in 2025. But the work has been delayed," he said.

K. Shanmugham, president of the Federation of North Chennai Residents' Welfare Associations, said residents complained about polluted drinking water in 33 areas, including Perambur and Vyasarpadi owing to sewage con-

tamination. Residents also raised concern over the slow pace of work at Ganesapuram Bridge and demanded that the Chennai Corporation complete the work ahead of the northeast monsoon. The bridge was announced in 2022 to ease traffic congestion and improve transport connectivity in north Chennai.

S. Saravanan, a trader in north Chennai, said: "We sent an email to the Commissioner after the new government was formed. Even though there has been an improvement in the pace of work, the officials have also reportedly indicated that the bridge might be completed only after the northeast monsoon. We want the work to be completed before that. Even after the Ganesapuram bridge is completed, the GCC has not planned any road widening to ease bottlenecks for traffic."

Ward 35 Councillor S. Jeevan said civic infrastructure work, including a ration shop with the councillor fund in Muthamizh Nagar, has been delayed because an assistant executive engineer of the GCC did not allow the contractor to carry out the work. "Before the election, the official asked the contractor to do the work after the election. Even after the election, the official concerned is not allowing the contractor to work," he alleged.

GCC officials said all the civic infrastructure projects would be expedited before the northeast monsoon.

'I could have become Deputy Chief Minister'

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

DMDK general secretary Premallatha Vijayakant on Sunday claimed her party did not aspire for any "position" contrary to the perception that the party "bargains" for seats, "sofa sets", or positions.

Speaking to reporters before a meeting of the party district secretaries in Chennai, she said the



Premallatha Vijayakant

DMDK remained "loyal" to the DMK when she could have easily allied with the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam after the polls.

"Even if we have just one seat, we are loyal to our alliance. Would it

have been so difficult for me to go and meet Vijay Minister? Wouldn't my partymen not come with me? Everyone is leaving to become a Minister. If I had told him [the Chief Minister], he would have offered me the position of Deputy Chief Minister," she contended.

Ms. Premallatha said the DMDK had stood with the AIADMK in 2024 Lok Sabha polls when al-

liance partners left it. "You all think that we quit the AIADMK alliance because of an [Rajya Sabha] MP seat. The cadre and district secretaries weren't respected (in the AIADMK). We formed an alliance with the DMK only because of it," she said.

According to her, Mr. Palaniswami continued to insult the DMDK even when all other AIADMK leaders wanted the party in the alliance.

Residents want bypass around Periyapalayam

Deepa H. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

Residents of Periyapalayam in Tiruvallur district want a bypass to be laid around the temple town. The present road runs via the Sri Bhavani Amman Temple and suffers from traffic bottlenecks during peak hours on most days.

The road from Janapachathram junction to Uthurkottai witnesses traffic jams for nearly four hours and running to a length of 1 to 2 km on either side.

Rajkumar, a resident of Thandalam village, said, "Earlier we used to have traffic jams during the month of Aadi and on Tuesdays and Fridays. Now, the number of vehicles taking the Janapachathram to Uthukottai Road has increased exponentially," he pointed out.

Social activist M. Bhas-

karan said encroachments along the road were not being removed. "When they are removed, small road-side vendors are only removed. Buildings taking up space on the side of the road remain. There are two bazaars along the road, one in Kanigaiper and another in Periyapalayam. There are times when people miss out on important occasions due to traffic. A bypass was announced long ago but is yet to be laid. Motorists from Avadi and Tiruvallur have to cross Periyapalayam to reach Siruvapuri," he added.

Highways Department sources said a proposal to construct a bypass for Periyapalayam was under consideration. It had been put on hold due to another road that was to be laid by the National Highways Authority of India.

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

OBITUARY

Mrs. PARVATHI RAMACHANDRAN
D.O.B: 21.04.1949 - D.O.D: 31.05.2026
Last Rites to be performed on today 01.06.2026
Deeply Mourned by:
H.A.Narayanan
S.Nagarajan
Mob: 8903906483

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

DEATH ANNIVERSARY

R. SUBRAMANI (RS)
1947 - 2025
One year ago today, we lost a loving husband, father, father-in-law, grandfather and friend. Not a day goes by that we don't think of you, miss your voice, your laughter, and your love. Your presence is deeply missed, but your memory lives on in every moment shared with family. We carry you with us always. Forever loved. Forever remembered.
The Subramani Family

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

5th YEAR ANNIVERSARY

SRIBALAVIGNESH
DOB: 06.06.1993 DOD: 01.06.2021
"VIGNESH" you are in our hearts...!!!
with love & fond memories
Ammu , Appa
Family & Friends

NINTH ANNIVERSARY

MR. T.M.BADRINATH
ON 01-06-2017
FONDLY REMEMBERED BY
SRIHARI BADRINATH
IN EVER LOVING MEMORY OF

S.PRABHAKARAN
"Who left us this day in 1978"
- FAMILY MEMBERS

Chennai Weather

max	min
Tiruvallur 40	26
Chennai Airport 40	29
Chennai City 39	29

Chennai Airport Today 39°C The weather will be hot with uneasy with moderate winds. Night also will be uneasy. Chances of light rain and thundershower.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow 40°C Morning will be uneasy. Day will be hot. Night also will be uneasy. Dry weather to occur.

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Timings
CHENNAI

MONDAY, JUN. 01		
RISE 05:42	SET 18:32	
RISE 19:33	SET 06:08	
TUESDAY, JUN. 02		
RISE 05:42	SET 18:32	
RISE 20:23	SET 06:59	
WEDNESDAY, JUN. 03		
RISE 05:42	SET 18:33	
RISE 21:11	SET 07:51	

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Online tenders are hereby invited from interested and eligible bidders for "Design, Supply, Installation and Commissioning of 2KW, 5KW and 10KW on-grid Solar Roof Top PV power plants for an aggregated capacity of 46705 KW for 9937 Nos. Schools with Topcon solar modules with Normal structure with RMS in 33 Districts with 5 years' comprehensive maintenance in the State of Telangana". Interested bidders can download the bids online from 30.05.2026 and submit the same, from 07.06.2026 to 22.06.2026 till 05:00PM through <https://www.tender.telangana.gov.in> For further details, please visit our website: <https://tgredco.telangana.gov.in>
Date: 30.05.2026
Sd/- VC & MD, TGREDCO
DIPR R.O.No.3337-PP/CL/ADVT/2026-27 Dt.30.05.2026

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INTEGRAL COACH FACTORY, CHENNAI-38

The following e-tender is published in IREPS website. Firms are requested to login to www.ireps.gov.in and quote against the tender. Manual Quotations will not be entertained for the tender.

Open Tender No.	Short Description of the Item.	Tender Value (₹)
2026499 212227	Works Contract for carrying out Installation of Window, Alarm Clip and Notices in EMU/MEMU Coaches	14,73,690.15
2026499 212232	Works contract for carrying out Installation and commissioning of stand alone aspiration Type Automatic Smoke/Fire detection with Alarm system for Kolkata Metro Coaches	8,48,006.24
2026499 212239	Works Contract for carrying out Flooring Works in LHB Coaches	53,80,218.15
2026499 212240	Works Contract for carrying out Flooring Works in EMU & MEMU Coaches	44,75,550.28

Date of tender Closing: 24.06.2026 at 14.45 Hrs/**Opening on** 24.06.2026 at 15.00 Hrs
Hindi version of the above advertisement is available in ICF website: <https://icf.indianrailways.gov.in>
By: Chief Mechanical Engineer/Fur-III

INTEGRAL COACH FACTORY, CHENNAI-38

Tender Notice No. ICF/PCMM/EOT/22/2026 Dated: 29.05.2026
The following e-tenders are published in IREPS website. Firms are requested to login to www.ireps.gov.in and quote against these tenders. Manual quotations will not be entertained for these tenders. Closing and Opening time for all tenders are 14.15 hrs. Hindi version of tender notice is available on website www.icf.indianrailways.gov.in.

Sl. No	Tender No.	Tender Title	Quantity	Due Date / Time
1	07261374A	ANTI THEFT ARRANGEMENT (WITH FASTENERS) FOR FIRE EXTINGUISHE	2082 Sets	29/05/2026
2	04251129B	ANTI RUST AGENT CORTEC VPCI 369 OR EQUIVALENT IN 25 LIT PACK.	1175 Litre	08/06/2026
3	01263057A	THROW AWAY INSERTS LNMX 301940	70 Nos	11/06/2026
4	07261819	S & I OF FRP MODULAR TOILET LSLRD AMRIT BHARAT	26 Sets	12/06/2026
5	06261728	SNI HEAT ARRGT PLUMBING MEMU	10 Sets	12/06/2026
6	08261436	Supply and Installation of KAVACH for SPIC KAVACH MOBILE	Refer-IREPS Web site	15/06/2026
7	07262141	SNI-C/S LADDER FOR LWFC/PP	9 sets	15/06/2026
8	03261738	NYLON BUSH DIA	Refer-IREPS Web site	16/06/2026
9	03261849	1.2mm thick CO2 solid coil wire	164010 kgs	16/06/2026
10	06261731	UNF VRLA BATTERY 120AH, 110V SYSTEM	243 sets	17/06/2026
11	06261645	UNF WATER TANK 30 LIT MOUNTING	3056 Nos	17/06/2026
12	06261504	FIRE EXTINGUISHER 6 KG CAPACITY	5209 Nos	18/06/2026
13	03261464	FINISH MACHINED AXLE BOX FRONT COVER FOR TACHO GENERATOR FIX...	5425 Nos	19/06/2026
14	03261810	CENTRE PIVOT PIN COMPLETE	2664 Nos	22/06/2026
15	02261471	S & I OF NOSE CONE (MEMU DMC)	58 Sets	26/06/2026

CORRIGENDUM NO.22
Corrigendum has been issued to the following tender. Please check IREPS website for further details

Sl.No	Tender No	Existing Value	Modified Value
01	02251980	29/05/2026	05/06/2026
		Additions and Deletions of Special Eligibility Criteria. Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website	
02	02261295	29/05/2026	05/06/2026
		Item Description Modified and Additions & Deletions of Drawing and spec. please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website	
03	03261554	25/05/2026	04/06/2026
		28/05/2026	08/06/2026
04	06252751	Item Description Modified and Additions & Deletions of Special Eligibility Criteria Technical Compliance, Check List, Drawing and spec. Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website	
05	06260053	25/05/2026	03/06/2026
06	08261247	01/06/2026	08/06/2027
		Additions of Drawing.Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	

THE HINDU
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INBRIEF



Cockroach Janta Party’s Kochi meeting fails to take place

A meeting of the Cockroach Janta Party, a digital political movement, scheduled to be held at Kochi in Kerala on Sunday, did not take place. Following announcements on social media about the proposed meeting on Marine Drive at 3 p.m., people gathered there, but the organisers did not turn up. The city police claimed that the meeting had been called off. “It is learnt that they have decided to take permission from the police before holding such a meet,” an officer said.

Kharge meets Telangana Cong. leaders in Hyderabad

Senior Congress leaders led by Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy called on AICC president Mallikarjun Kharge during his brief stopover in Hyderabad while *en route* to Kalaburagi in Karnataka on Sunday. Mr. Reddy, Deputy Chief Minister Bhatti Vikramarka, AICC Telangana in-charge Meenakshi Natarajan, TPCC president Mahesh Kumar Goud, Government Adviser Harkara Venugopal Rao and AICC secretary Sampath Kumar were in the meeting.

5 killed, 10 injured in accident on NH-44 in Chikkaballapur

Five persons were killed and more than 10 sustained serious injuries in a road accident on National Highway no. 44 near Gangotri Petrol Bunk on the outskirts of Bagepalli town in Chikkaballapur district of Karnataka on Sunday. Preliminary investigations suggest that an SUV at a high speed rammed the autorickshaw from behind. The impact caused the autorickshaw to lose control and crash into a mini-lorry moving ahead, triggering a collision.

Five drown in Tungabhadra in A.P., bodies recovered

The Hindu Bureau
KURNOOL

The bodies of all the five persons who drowned in the Tungabhadra river near Mantralayam in Andhra Pradesh on Saturday evening were retrieved by rescue workers on Sunday. Rescue workers also fished out the body of an unidentified person during the search. The five victims, hailing from Anantapur and Kurnool districts in A.P., and Hyderabad in neighbouring Telangana, had come to Mantralayam to attend a family function. After attending a ritual, they, along with some others, entered the river waters. The tragedy occurred when six members were swept away by currents as they entered deep inside the river after reportedly misjudging the depth of the water. While five persons drowned, one person managed to come out of the waters.

Night-long search
Assisted by expert swimmers and local fishermen, the rescue teams searched for the victims throughout the night and managed to trace them by Sunday afternoon. The deceased were identified as Satish (35) and his five-year-old son Yuvan Chandra from Hyderabad, Raghavendra (25) and Dhanu (23) from Mantralayam, and Sandhya (22) from Ura-vakonda in Anantapur district. The rescue workers recovered the body of an unidentified person aged around 70 during the search operation. Police are trying to ascertain the identity of the person.

Cong. weighs caste equations in race for next KPCC president

‘We need to look at the right combination to make this appointment,’ says Kharge; party sources say names of many leaders are coming in

The Hindu Bureau
KALABURAGI/BENGALURU

With Karnataka Pradesh Congress Committee (KPCC) president D.K. Shivakumar set to take over as the Chief Minister on Wednesday, the party is looking at multiple leaders and caste combinations to identify his successor to lead the party organisation. All India Congress Committee president Mallikarjun Kharge told presspersons in Karnataka’s Kalaburagi on Sunday that discussions are actively under way to find a successor for the lead position of party State unit. “Naturally, a replacement of the KPCC chief must take place now. We need to evaluate good candidates and look at the right combination to make this appointment. From the perspective of the party’s future and strengthening its organisation, we need a dynamic leader,” he added.

Party sources said that besides Satish Jarkiholi, who has emerged as the frontrunner in the race for the KPCC president’s post, names of other leaders are also coming up for discussion. These names are cropping up as part of caste and regional combinations that are being dis-



KPCC president D.K. Shivakumar with All India Congress Committee chief Mallikarjun Kharge in New Delhi on May 29. ANI

As several names emerge for the post, Kharge says party will look for the ‘right combination’

cussed with regard to the Cabinet formation, and ultimately, the decision will be part of the power-sharing agreement between Mr. Shivakumar and outgoing Chief Minister Siddaramaiah, sources said. Mr. Kharge said, “We have only around 24 months remaining in the current legislative term, and the incoming leader should be one who can work at a rapid pace, foster collective unity, and take everyone along. At the same time, there must be a strong team of party workers and leaders who can

cooperate and work in tandem with the new chief. Weighing all these aspects, we are deliberating on the matter.”

Coordination panel
The proposal to form a coordination committee – headed by Mr. Siddaramaiah to build consensus on contentious issues – which is being pushed by some party seniors received support publicly from senior Dalit Left Minister K.H. Muniyappa. “The coordination committee is most important and badly required in any political party,” he told presspersons in Bengaluru on Sunday. A coordination committee headed by Mr. Siddaramaiah functioned during the Janata Dal (Secular)-Congress government in 2018-19.

New railway zone in A.P. set to begin operations

V. Kamalakara Rao
VISAKHAPATNAM

The South Coast Railway (SCoR) zone in Andhra Pradesh, India’s 18th railway zone, will be fully operational from Monday, marking a significant milestone in the region’s railway infrastructure. Headquartered in Visakhapatnam, the zone was constituted following a Gazette notification issued by the Ministry of Railways on May 4, 2026.

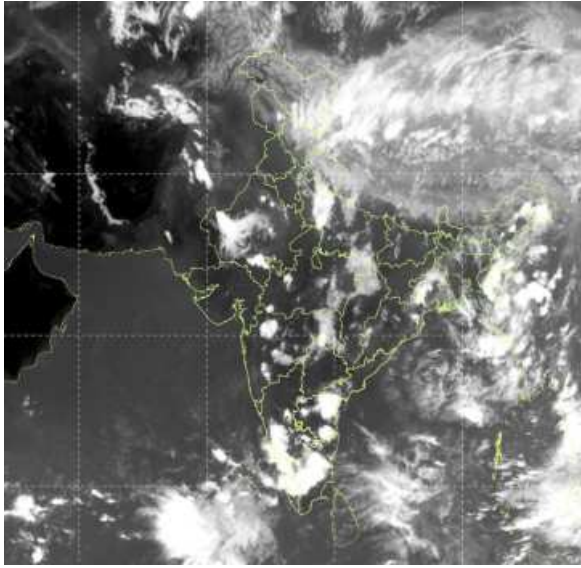
The administrative setup of the new zone is in place and Sandeep Mathur is the General Manager, railway sources told *The Hindu* on Sunday. Mr. Mathur has been overseeing infrastructure projects, including capacity augmentation and track development, particularly the third- and fourth-line projects in the Visakhapatnam area.

The SCoR zone has four divisions: Visakhapatnam, Vijayawada, Guntakal and Guntur.

It covers a rail network across Andhra Pradesh and parts of Karnataka and Tamil Nadu. Its principal officers include Vineet Kumar (Principal Chief Operations Manager), T.K. Sinha (Principal Chief Electrical Engineer), B.S.K. Raj Kumar (Principal Chief Engineer), P. Hariprasad (Principal Financial Advisor), L.V.S.S. Patrudu (Principal Chief Personnel Officer), D. Satyanarayana (Chief Commercial Manager/co-ordination) and B. Chandra Sekhar (Officer on Special Duty).

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 17:00 HRS)

Forecast for Monday: Heavy rainfall very likely in Gujarat, Kerala, Mahe, Lakshadweep, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Odisha, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal and West Madhya Pradesh. Thunderstorm with hailstorm very likely at isolated places over Madhya Maharashtra, Odisha and West Madhya Pradesh

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN		
Agartala		35.6	25.8	Kurnool		39.5	28.1		
Ahmedabad		3.0	40.0	23.8	Lucknow		36.3	24.7	
Aizawl		0.2	32.8	20.0	Madurai		39.0	27.6	
Bengaluru		11.0	32.1	20.5	Mangaluru		33.0	24.5	
Bhopal			37.1	22.4	Mumbai		35.8	29.0	
Bhubaneswar		37.4	26.5	Mysuru		14.0	32.0	22.0	
Chandigarh		18.2	32.0	20.4	New Delhi		0.2	35.1	22.5
Chennai		40.2	29.2	Patna			36.1	27.6	
Coimbatore			35.6	24.6	Port Blair		54.0	31.6	25.0
Dehradun		30.1	26.6	20.0	Prayagraj			38.8	26.0
Gangtok			26.0	16.4	Puducherry			37.8	28.4
Gobindpur			35.4	28.8	Pune			37.0	26.7
Guwahati			35.4	25.7	Raipur		0.4	40.6	24.6
Hubballi			37.0	28.0	Ranchi		5.0	33.0	21.0
Hyderabad			39.0	29.2	Shillong			26.8	16.5
Imphal		2.0	29.5	22.1	Shimla		5.0	21.6	11.5
Jaipur		4.2		21.4	Srinagar			29.8	14.5
Kochi		3.0	31.0	26.6	Thiruvananthapuram		6.0	31.3	25.6
Kohima					Thiruchirappalli			40.3	28.4
Kolkata			36.6	25.2	Vijayawada			42.6	28.0
Kozhikode			35.2	27.0	Visakhapatnam		3.0	34.1	26.0

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing							Yesterday
CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	
Ahmedabad		4	19	61	46	101	In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Angul, Odisha recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 324 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu recorded a healthy AQI score of 24
Bengaluru		4	18	42	41	99	
Chennai		2	14		40	80	
Delhi		19	51	12	110	73	
Hyderabad		13	18	23	50	92	
Kolkata		8	25	39	66	94	
Lucknow		8	18	37	66	55	
Mumbai		13	103	29	21	51	
Pune			18	67	36	54	
Visakhapatnam		11	33	18	56	106	

Air Quality Code: ■ Poor ■ Moderate ■ Good (Readings indicate average AQI)
SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.
NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.
CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.
PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Holiday rush



Vacation vibes: Tourists visit the Charminar in Telangana’s Hyderabad on Sunday during the summer vacation, as families make the most of the final days of the school holidays before classes resume. SIDDHANT THAKUR

Revanth to go on a State-wide tour, launch multiple projects

R. Ravikanth Reddy
HYDERABAD

Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy will embark on an extensive multi-district five-day tour across the State beginning June 1, inaugurating welfare programmes, laying foundation stones for major infrastructure projects, reviewing irrigation works, and addressing public meetings.

Five-day tour
The tour is expected to showcase the State government’s focus on housing, agriculture, irrigation, transport and women’s empowerment. Mr. Reddy will begin his tour with a vi-



Revanth Reddy

sit to Adilabad district on June 1, where he will launch the second phase of the Indiramma Housing Scheme. On June 3, Mr. Reddy will visit Koheda in Rangareddy district to lay the foundation stone for a massive integrated market project. The proposed market,

spread over 239 acres, will be developed with modern facilities aimed at strengthening agricultural trade, logistics and market access for farmers and traders. Officials said the project is expected to emerge as one of Telangana’s largest agricultural trading hubs. Mr. Reddy’s tour will conclude with a major programme at the Secunderabad Parade Ground on June 5, where 553 buses procured at ₹199 crore will be distributed to women’s self-help groups. Under the initiative, the groups will own the buses and lease them to the Telangana State Road Transport Corporation, creating income-generating opportunities.

Signs of truce as son of SNDP Yogam general secretary calls on Kerala CM

G. Anand
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Signs of a temporary truce appeared to emerge between SNDP Yogam general secretary Vellappally Natesan and Kerala Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan on Sunday. Mr. Natesan’s son Thushar Vellappally visited Mr. Satheesan’s home in Aluva, Ernakulam, with a bevy of SNDP Yogam leaders in tow. Almost simultaneously, Labour Minister Bindhu Krishna called on Mr. Natesan at his house at Kana-chikulangara, Alappuzha. Mr. Natesan’s alarmingly bitter criticism of Mr. Satheesan, often bordering on the personal, had, in



SNDP Yogam vice-president Thushar Vellappally and others with Kerala CM V.D. Satheesan in Aluva on Sunday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

some measure, animated the political debate during the Assembly election campaign. However, Mr. Natesan had signalled a climbdown after the Congress named Mr. Satheesan

as the United Democratic Front’s Chief Minister-designate. Mr. Natesan also seemed to execute a volte-face by stating that he had never questioned Mr. Sath-

eesan’s merit for holding high political office. Mr. Thushar Vellappally, who is the SNDP Yogam vice-president and the National Democratic Alliance (NDA)’s State convener, projected an air of nonchalance after meeting Mr. Satheesan. “The general secretary [Mr. Natesan] has said good and bad things [about Mr. Satheesan]. But the SNDP Yogam has not worked against him at the hustings,” Mr. Thushar Vellappally said. On his part, Mr. Satheesan had publicly stated that he would not personally attack Mr. Natesan, given the latter’s age and the social import of the organisation he headed.

Towards a dialogue on adolescent sexuality

A recent judgment of the Supreme Court of India, allowing the medical termination of pregnancy at 28 weeks, has received significant media attention. Much of this attention stems from the arguments advanced on behalf of the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), which has sought for a reconsideration of the judgment.

Doctors at AIIMS argued that what the court described as a medical termination of pregnancy would, in reality, involve delivering a living child at 28 weeks, one likely to be born with serious medical complications, long-term co-morbidities and disabilities. They asked that the delivery be pushed by six weeks to improve the child's chances of survival. These arguments were rejected by the court in rather strong terms.

A doctor's ethical burden
The nature of the doctors' argument is not inherently distinct from claims about a (much younger) foetus' interest in being carried to term. In both cases, more time in the womb increases the chances of survival outside it. However, since a 28-week foetus is at a more advanced stage of gestation, two things change about the claim.

First, doctors are better able to predict both the foetus' chances of survival and the medical complications it may face, making concerns about neo-natal care and future health more concrete. Second, and not unrelatedly, the ethical burden of the doctor who must perform the delivery increases significantly. Where a foetus is not viable, the doctor's sole obligation is to the pregnant woman. But where a living child may be delivered, the doctor's obligations extend to that child as well. A doctor may, therefore, experience the procedure not merely as an abortion, but as a medically induced premature delivery that immediately creates an obligation to preserve life.



Shraddha Chaudhary
Assistant Professor,
School of Law, BML
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Policies such as the ban on condom advertisements between 6.00 a.m. and 10.00 p.m., and a generally repressive culture around sex brush questions of sex and sexuality under the carpet

While the court's order protects her from legal action, it does not extinguish her ethical and moral obligations as a doctor and as a human being.

None of this necessarily undermines the court's decision. Faced with an unwed minor who had reportedly attempted suicide twice, the court understandably prioritised her reproductive autonomy and well-being. But the doctors' objections, though framed as concern for the unborn child, also reflect a potent anxiety: the ethical burden placed on medical professionals asked to perform such procedures at the edge of foetal viability. This burden need not change how we think about the outcome of the case, but it deserves to be acknowledged for the ethical tensions underlining it.

On adolescent sexual activity
These ethical tensions are not accidental or anomalous. The immense trauma endured by the unwed minor, the predicament of the unborn but viable foetus, and the ethical burden of the doctors are all symptomatic of a deeper structural issue. Cases like these arise because of a serious and largely unnoticed failure of the state to deal appropriately with the phenomenon of teenage sex. In this case, a de-facto consensual sexual relationship between a 15-year-old girl and her 17-year-old partner resulted in pregnancy. The pregnancy went unnoticed until the minor's mother reportedly observed 'an unusual heaviness' in her abdomen, by which time it was already too advanced to terminate without court intervention. This is because the Medical Termination of Pregnancy Act, as amended in 2021, does not allow abortions beyond 24 weeks even in exceptional circumstances.

The Indian state's approach to the issue has largely been one of blanket criminalisation: all sexual activity involving minors is treated as a criminal offence, regardless of whether it involves coercion,

exploitation, or de-facto consensual sexual activity between adolescents. Studies from the U.S. have shown that abstinence-only policies fail to prevent adolescents from having sex. Empirical studies on the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act, 2012 (POCSO) in India have also repeatedly shown that nearly 10-15% of all cases before the POCSO special courts involve de-facto consensual relationships, and there is nothing to suggest that the law manages to deter such sex amongst adolescents.

If anything, this criminalisation works in tandem with the absence of adequate and comprehensive sex education in educational institutions.

Policies such as the ban on condom advertisements between 6.00 a.m. and 10.00 p.m., and a generally repressive culture around sex brush questions of sex and sexuality under the carpet. Instead of teaching adolescents the essentials of safe sex, menstruation, sexually transmitted diseases and pregnancy, the answer to all questions around sex and sexuality is reduced to a simplistic "don't do it". However, preventing cases such as this is more likely to require comprehensive sex education and an emphasis on safe sexual practices.

The way forward
Such policies require a more nuanced conversation around adolescent sexuality, in which we are willing to acknowledge that de-facto consensual sexual interactions involving adolescents exist and should not be conflated with instances of child rape and exploitation. They also require a commitment to steady long-term measures, which may not provide short-term rhetorical gains.

Thus, if our concern is truly the well-being of adolescents, the solution is not a refusal to acknowledge their sexuality but a commitment to engage with it honestly and meaningfully.

How T.N.'s healthcare leads by example

The State offers the country a healthcare system that is accessible

STATE OF PLAY

G.S.K. Velu

For many years in India, healthcare progress was largely measured by hospital expansions, medical colleges and public health infrastructure. While these remain important, the next phase of healthcare reform requires a broader, integrated approach that links infrastructure with accessibility, workforce capability, diagnostics, technology and long-term outcomes. In this context, Tamil Nadu provides an example.

The State's healthcare strengths did not emerge overnight. They resulted from decades of institutional focus on primary healthcare, maternal and child health, medical education, disease prevention, public health outreach and decentralised healthcare delivery. The Tamil Nadu Medical Service Corporation (TNMSC) is an aspirational model, established in 1994 to streamline procurement, storage and distribution of essential medicines across government institutions. By improving availability and reducing inefficiencies, the TNMSC became a national reference for public-sector drug procurement. This reform showed that healthcare progress is not just about building hospitals, but about creating systems that make care accessible and accountable.

Over time, Tamil Nadu has created a mature healthcare ecosystem combining public health infrastructure with private partnerships. The 8,700 sub-health centres across districts reinforce a larger principle: strong healthcare systems are built when investment is distributed evenly rather than being



concentrated only in urban hospitals.

One of the State's key strengths is its emphasis on diagnostics in primary healthcare. Public health programmes and community screenings now reach lakhs of citizens across urban and rural regions. For a large, diverse country such as India, primary care systems with robust diagnostics are essential. Early diagnosis reduces pressure on tertiary hospitals, thereby curbing long-term treatment costs. Another important lesson is decentralised healthcare delivery. Investments of nearly ₹360 crore in district hospitals and local microbiology laboratory networks reduce regional disparities in healthcare access.

On integrating technology
Technology also plays a defining role in the next phase of healthcare delivery. AI, digital health records, telemedicine and remote diagnostics can improve efficiency and extend access to underserved areas. Tamil Nadu's focus on digital public health systems and data-led healthcare governance is therefore an important development.

Equally important is healthcare workforce capacity. A core focus at the Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI) is workforce upskilling and future-ready care. Tamil Nadu attracts patients from across

India owing to its government institutes and medical colleges. Building physical infrastructure without parallel investments in workforce development risks creating facilities without operational strength. Continuous upskilling in diagnostics, digital health technologies, AI-assisted systems and multidisciplinary models helps build a sustainable ecosystem.

Tamil Nadu is also well placed to become a preferred manufacturing destination for medical devices and equipment, leveraging its existing strengths in auto components, electronics and precision engineering. Reducing import dependency will be critical to strengthening the State's healthcare provisioning further. Lastly, strong collaboration between public and private sectors is essential in addressing systemic challenges. While public health systems provide scale and reach, private healthcare, diagnostics, Med-Tech and digital health ecosystems contribute to innovation, technology and specialised capabilities.

However, it is also important to recognise that even relatively mature healthcare systems face challenges. Patient load pressures, workforce distribution gaps, operational bottlenecks remain concerns across Indian States.

The lesson from Tamil Nadu is not about replicating an identical structure – but about replicating the underlying principles of sustained investments, decentralised delivery, workforce development and technology-enabled systems. That is the blueprint India must now pursue.

Dr. G.S.K. Velu is Chairman FICCI Tamil Nadu State Council and CMD Trivitrion Healthcare /Neuberg Diagnostics/Maxivision Eye Hospitals

Prisons in India continue to be overcrowded by undertrials

More than half of the States/UTs had an occupancy rate of over 100% in 2024 despite a modest increase in capacity

DATA POINT

Sambavi Parthasarathy

While the latest Prison Statistics report released by the National Crime Records Bureau show that the occupancy rate in Indian jails fell to a decade-low of 112.7% in 2024, data shows that overcrowding remains a persisting problem in Indian prisons driven largely by a high share of undertrials. The report also highlighted other concerns such as insufficient capacity expansion and high levels of staff vacancies.

In more than half of the States/Union Territories (UTs) in India, prisons continue to operate beyond their sanctioned capacity. At the end of 2024, the country had about 1,333 jails with a capacity of 4.53 lakh inmates. However, with an inmate population of over 5.11 lakh, prisons continued to be overcrowded.

A Parliamentary Committee report, titled 'Prison- Conditions, Infrastructure and Reforms', noted that overcrowding strains resources, compromises living standards, increases tensions among inmates and limits their access to healthcare and rehabilitation facilities. It also recommended various measures such as the constructions of new buildings, barracks and prisons, transfers to other jails and free legal aid.

While the total number of jails remained lower than the pre-pandemic period, prison capacity has increased by 24% between 2015 and 2024 largely due to renovations and expansions which were carried out across 2,268 prisons in this period (**Chart 1**). Over 120 prisons were newly constructed in these years.

Though overall capacity has improved modestly, several States are yet to catch up. A Statewise analysis shows that more than half of the States had an occupancy rate of over 100% in 2024. Delhi re-

corded the highest occupancy rate in the country at 194% in 2024, much like the previous year when its occupancy rate stood at 200% (**Chart 2**). Other major States/UTs which saw high occupancy rates include Jammu and Kashmir, where occupancy rates increased from a mere 78% in 2015 to over 148% in 2023 and 2024.

However, the levels have relatively reduced in States such as Uttar Pradesh and Chhattisgarh which had previously registered higher occupancy rates. For instance, Chhattisgarh registered an occupancy rate of 234% in 2015. As per the latest report, this figure has decreased to 127.6%.

This problem of overcrowded prisons can be attributed to the disproportionately higher share of undertrials – who accounted for about 73% of the total inmate population in 2024 (**Chart 3**). While this is much lower than in 2021, when the undertrial population in prison peaked at about 77%, this is still higher than pre-COVID periods. On the other hand, the share of convicts in prisons reduced from about 32% in 2016 to 26.6% in 2024.

A Statewise analysis shows that in about 14 States/UTs, the share of undertrials is higher than the all India average (**Chart 4**). With over 87% of its inmates being undertrials, Delhi and Bihar were the two major States/UTs to have the highest share of undertrial population in their prisons.

Further, the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Home Affairs also expressed concern that the high levels of staff vacancies has become the most neglected part of prison administration. States/UTs such as Delhi and Jammu which registered higher occupancy rates and a higher share of undertrials also had a higher share of staff vacancies. Almost half of the sanctioned posts remained vacant in about 8 States/UTs. At least 60% of its sanctioned prison staff remained vacant in Delhi and Jammu and Kashmir.

Arrested development

The data for the charts were sourced from the Prison Statistics India report, published by the National Crime Records Bureau

Chart 1: The total number of jails (left axis) and available capacity (right axis) at the end of each year

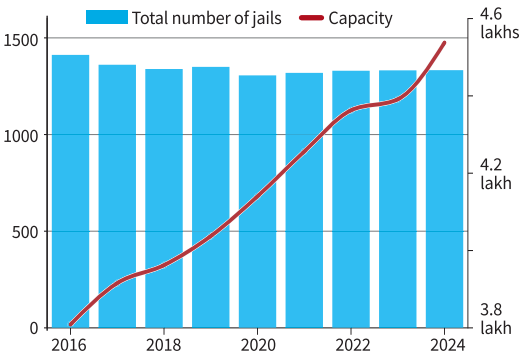


Chart 3: Types of prison inmates in jails between 2016 and 2024. Undertrials disproportionately form a higher share of inmates

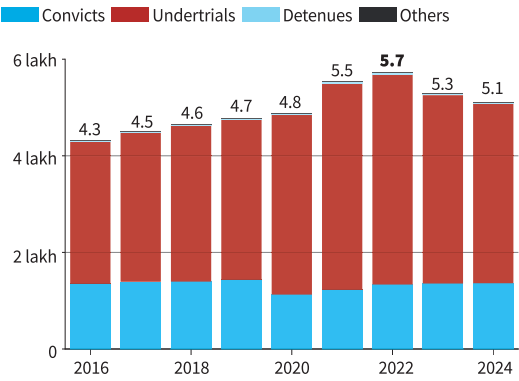


Chart 4: Undertrials as a share of the total population of inmates in 2024. The chart shows only select States in which the share of undertrials exceed the national average

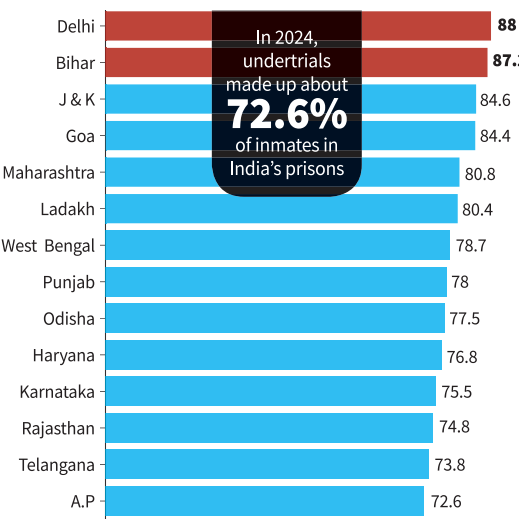
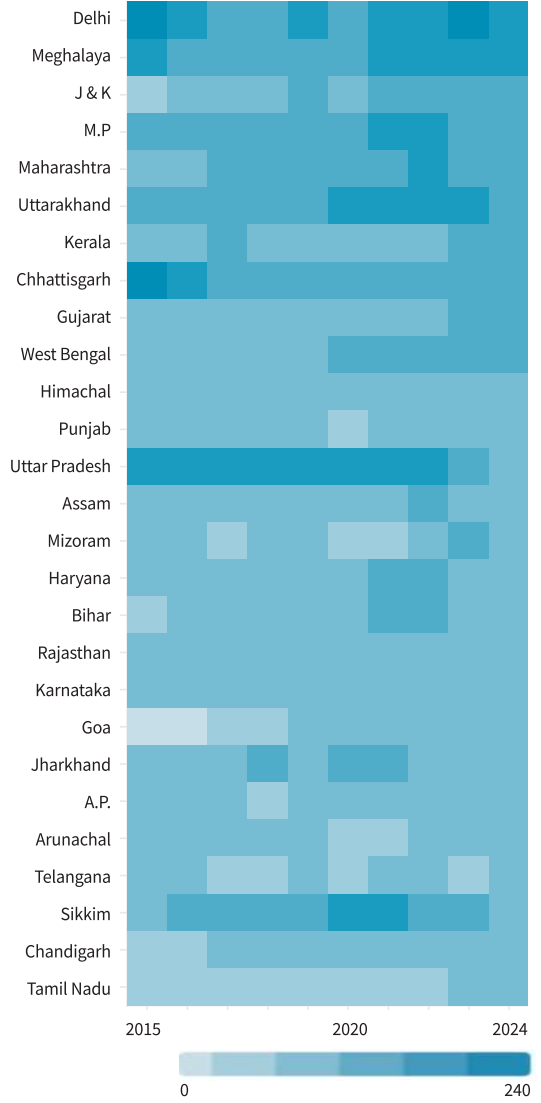


Chart 2: Prison occupancy rates in select States/UTs in the 2015-2024 period. The darker the blue, the higher the occupancy rate



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO JUNE 1, 1976

Communists 'active' in Singapore

Singapore, May 31: The Singapore government on Thursday announced that beneath the surface of calm in Singapore extensive clandestine activities by communists had been going on in the Republic to recruit people from higher strata of society including members of the Armed Forces.

A Ministry of Home Affairs statement said that since January this year 50 persons had been arrested, among whom were a Singapore Navy officer and a few Navy personnel, a proprietor of a firm, a contractor, a sales manager and an Australian-trained principal of a ballet school.

The Ministry said that the links had been traced from underground cells in Singapore to contact points in Kuala Lumpur and Johore in Malaysia, Betong in south Thailand, Bangkok and Hong Kong.

The recent raids by security officials constituted the third major security operation since 1964 when 113 were arrested. In the June 1974 operation, a lawyer and two Chinese journalists were among those arrested.

The new members' motivation to join the communists is not necessarily ideological or economic. Some of the arrested were chauvinists, some victims of communist literature and others dissatisfied with the Government's policies.

Prominent among those arrested are of Chinese origin and connected with the Malayan Peoples Liberation League, the political wing of the CPM-Marxist-Leninist group, said to be Russian-oriented, while the CPM is Maoist.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO JUNE 1, 1926

New steel alloy discovered

Rugby, May 31: The discovery of a new steel alloy is announced by Sir Robert Hadfield, head of Hadfields Limited, the great Sheffield Steel Firm. As indication of the high temperature which the alloy will heat, a gas turbine has been constructed which runs at 55,000 revolutions a minute at a working temperature of 1655 degrees Fahrenheit.

It is stated that the machines made with this steel can be worked at bright red heat and the discovery is expected to prove of great importance in the application of high temperature gases.

From Page One

‘Vulnerabilities in CBSE platform contained’

“I sent my first report to the CBSE on February 25, and within three to four days, they took the portal down,” he said. “Six or seven vulnerabilities were still active and exploitable later but the CBSE did not respond to my e-mails. This was pretty frustrating. I noticed that the CBSE had poorly managed infrastructure and the passwords used were easy to guess,” Mr. Adhikary said.

Earlier, the Board had rejected claims that its evaluation platform had been compromised. Mr. Adhikary had countered this claim.

On May 30, Mr. Adhikary managed to hack into the CBSE’s Principals dashboard in the On-Screen Marking platform. “The dashboard and the portal had had 9.3 million columns and rows of sensitive student data, including images of answer sheets of students which lay unprotected and could be easily tampered with,” he said.

He has alleged that there are data sovereignty issues with how COEMPT Eduteck [the CBSE’s technology vendor] handled sensitive student exam data. He has alleged that an Amazon Web Services (AWS) bucket containing 2026 answer sheets and question papers could be accessed without authentication.

“COEMPT should have ideally stored the data on their own servers, but they took the ‘cheap easy route’ of storing answer sheets in Amazon Web Services public buckets without security checks,” Mr. Adhikary said. Sensitive data, including personal information of students, was processed by Google’s Gemini in automation scripts prepared by quality assurance engineers of COEMPT, he added. Mr. Adhikary called this “scary” and “sad”, where a third party sends such data to the U.S. for processing. “Data Privacy Laws are not respected and they [the company] should get sued for doing this without student consent,” he said.

Congress leaders to take Cabinet talks to Delhi

Some senior leaders, who had not made the Siddaramaiah’s Cabinet, such as B.R. Patil, Tanveer Sait and Vijayanand Kashappanavar, also met Mr. Shivakumar seeking an opportunity as the government is left with little less than two years.

The high command is also likely to intervene on behalf of some legislators to provide a finality to the list, sources said. On the number of Ministers to be sworn in on Wednesday, Mr. Kharge said no formal proposal had reached the party high command. There would be clarity on it by Wednesday, he said. “Decisions regarding how many Ministers need to be inducted, how many deputy Chief Ministers are required, and whether the appointments of chairpersons to crucial State corporations should happen simultaneously will be decided after a concrete proposal,” he said.

Meanwhile, Mr. Shivakumar and Mr. Siddaramaiah will be carrying their list of choices for the berths during their visit to Delhi on Monday.

Enumeration for Phase 3 of SIR exercise begins

During the enumeration phase, booth-level officers (BLOs) will conduct house-to-house visits and provide enumeration forms to all existing electors, who can then submit the filled forms either through the BLO or online. To ensure maximum coverage, the BLOs will visit each household, for distribution, collection, and verification of forms.

During house-to-house enumeration, the BLOs must carry at least 30 blank Form 6 copies along with blank declaration forms, to supply anyone who seeks to enrol as a new elector.

With a view to widen political party involvement, the EC has allowed the booth-level agents (BLAs) of recognised political parties to collect up to 50 forms per day from the public, and hand it over to the BLO before the publication of draft rolls. National- and State-recognised political parties may appoint more BLAs to assist BLOs in the smooth and effective conduct of the SIR process, the EC said.

With the third phase, the SIR exercise will cover the entire country except Himachal Pradesh, Jammu and Kashmir, and Ladakh.

‘Nepal has encroached upon Indian territory’

After Mr. Shah’s remarks created a furore, the Nepal Ministry of Foreign Affairs issued a statement clarifying that the issue raised by the Prime Minister was “primarily related to encroachment in the Dasgaja area (no-man’s land)” and “cross-border occupation” – that is, the use or possession of land across the border. “...situations have arisen where citizens of one country cultivate land or reside on land that falls within the territory of the other country,” the Ministry said.

“Studies conducted by the technical committee have shown that, in some places, land currently being used and occupied by Nepal may actually fall on the Indian side of the border...,” the Ministry added. “The Prime Minister’s statement in Parliament that ‘in some places, Indian land may be on Nepal’s side’ was made in reference to this technical reality and the issue of cross-border occupation.”

Six die as building collapses in Delhi; locals blame negligence

The five-storey structure collapsed on canteen where doctors, aspirants preparing for govt. exams were having food; Delhi govt. suspends two MCD engineers; building was uninhabitable, say locals

Shrimansi Kaushik
NEW DELHI

Six people – five doctors and a canteen owner – died as a five-storey building collapsed and fell on a canteen adjacent to it in the Saidulajab area of Mehrauli here on Saturday evening. Residents alleged that the building was uninhabitable and illegal construction was going on despite the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) issuing notice to the owner based on a complaint.

The Delhi government suspended two MCD engineers on Sunday while the police registered a case of negligence. After the collapse, at least 13 persons were rescued from the rubble, most of them doctors or NEET-PG and FMGE aspirants. “Those rescued were taken immediately to AIIMS Trauma Centre and Safdarjung hospital for treatment. While five were declared brought dead, five were admitted for treatment. Three were discharged after treatment,” said a senior police official.

The police registered an FIR under Sections 105



Rescue works under way after a five-storey building collapsed on Saturday evening in Saket, Delhi, on Sunday. SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

(culpable homicide not amounting to murder), 290 (negligent conduct regarding construction of buildings) and 125 (a) (negligent act endangering human life) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

Exam aspirants

The deceased were Kapil Lohaniya, Alok Verma, Ravi Singh, Nalin Roy, Ekta Chaudhary, and Parvati Ojha. At least three of them hailed from other States and were preparing for various government exams in Delhi. Among the six deceased, five were doctors and one was the owner of the canteen where they were having food when the building collapsed.

The area houses many aspirants who prepare for government exams and has multiple coaching centres. The building that collapsed had a corporate office and a library among other facilities.

Ojha, 39, ran ‘Auntie Canteen’ in Saidulajab, right next to the building that collapsed. “I was there at the canteen with other workers. Parvati saw the building falling and raised an alarm. She appealed to everyone to run outside. She had almost stepped out but went back inside to see if anyone was left when a beam of concrete fell on her head,” said her nephew.

“There were at least 14

persons inside the canteen when the building fell. The building itself might have had a few more people,” he added. Chief Minister Rekha Gupta visited the site on Sunday morning following which the two MCD engineers – Aman Jain (Junior Engineer) and Sudesh Singh Chouhan (Assistant Engineer) – from South Zone were suspended.

According to a resident, the building was at least 20 years old. “Earlier, there were only three floors. This year, two more floors were added and the construction of the sixth floor was going on,” said Abdul Sakir, who had registered a complaint with the MCD in March about the illegal construction. “But no action was taken.”

Anand Kumar, a resident of Saidulajab, also said the building already had up to five floors. “It was known among locals that the building was uninhabitable and the MCD had also issued notices to the owner. Now, we hear about how the MCD had presented in the High Court that construction had been stopped, which was not true,” he added.

General Subramani takes charge as CDS; lays emphasis on ‘JAI’

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI



Gen. N.S. Raja Subramani

General N.S. Raja Subramani on Sunday assumed charge as India’s third Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) and Secretary, Department of Military Affairs.

Soon after assuming office, General Subramani paid tribute to fallen soldiers by laying a wreath at the National War Memorial in New Delhi. He was later accorded a ceremonial Tri-Services Guard of Honour at South Block.

Addressing reporters, the new CDS expressed gratitude for the trust reposed in the armed forces and reaffirmed his commitment to strengthening national security through greater integration among the services. “The Indian Army, Navy, Air Force, Ministry of Defence, strategic institutions and all stakeholders stand united as part of the Whole of Nation approach to strengthen India’s security,” he said.

He said the armed forces would work towards implementing Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s vision of “JAI” – Jointness, *Atma Nirbharta* (self-sufficiency), and Innovation. He

said organisational reforms aimed at enhancing synergy, integration, and operational effectiveness among the three services would remain a key focus area. “*Atma Nirbharta* is a central pillar of our national security. We will accelerate the development, induction, and integration of indigenous weapons in our armed forces,” he said, while stressing the need for innovation in thought and action.

A highly decorated officer with more than four decades of service, General Subramani was commissioned into the Garhwal Rifles in December 1985. He has held several key command and staff appointments, including General Officer Commanding 2 Corps, GOC-in-C Central Command, and Vice Chief of the Army Staff.

Odisha govt. clears key road for Vedanta’s mining project

Satyasundar Barik
BHUBANESWAR



Vedanta’s Sijimali project has faced resistance from locals fearing that mining may adversely affect their livelihoods. BISWARANJAN ROUT

The Odisha government has granted permission for the construction of a road connecting State Highway 44 and Sijimali hilltop to facilitate the transportation of bauxite in Kshipur block of Rayagada district.

Sijimali, with an estimated 311 million tonnes of bauxite, was allocated to Vedanta in March 2023. The mineral is crucial for the Vedanta Group to keep its alumina refinery at Lanjigarh running. However, the project has since been facing resistance from local people, who fear that mining activity could dry up streams and adversely impact their livelihood.

For several months, villagers have been living in makeshift shelters atop the hill, keeping a round-the-clock watch to prevent the construction of the road from Bichhapinda along SH-44 to Sijimali hilltop.

The State-run Odisha Industrial Infrastructure Development Corporation (IDCO) had applied for the diversion of 4.911 hectares of forest land for the construction of an access road from Sijimali bauxite mines (Hill Top) to SH-44 to facilitate bauxite transportation.

The Union Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change granted Stage-I (in-principle) approval for diversion of the forest land in January 2026. Subsequently, consi-

dering the compliance with the conditions laid down under the ‘Stage-II in-principle’ approval, the Ministry granted Stage-II approval (final) under Section-2 (I) (ii) of the Van (Sanrakshan Evam Samvardhan) Adhiniyam, 1980, for non-forestry use of 4.911 hectares of forest land in favour of the IDCO on May 6.

Following the final approval, the State has now allowed non-forestry use of 4.911 hectares for road construction.

Admiral Swaminathan takes charge as 27th chief of Navy

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI



Adm. Krishna Swaminathan with outgoing Navy chief Adm. Dinesh Kumar Tripathi in New Delhi. SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

Admiral Krishna Swaminathan on Sunday assumed charge as the 27th Chief of the Naval Staff (CNS) of the Indian Navy, succeeding Admiral Dinesh Kumar Tripathi, who retired after over 41 years of service.

Soon after taking over the command of the maritime force, Admiral Swaminathan reaffirmed the Navy’s commitment to protecting national and economic interests amid an increasingly complex regional security environment. Speaking to reporters on the occasion, the new Navy chief said he was honoured to lead the force at a time when maritime security challenges continue to evolve.

“I’m extremely grateful to have this opportunity to serve the Indian Navy and the nation in this capacity. The Indian Navy stands vi-

gilant to protect national interests and is actively deployed in a regional security environment that remains challenging, complex, unpredictable and uncertain,” he said.

Highlighting his priorities as the Chief of the Naval Staff, Admiral Swaminathan stressed the importance of maintaining the highest standards of operational readiness and combat effectiveness. He said the Navy would conti-

nue its ongoing modernisation drive while accelerating the induction of niche and emerging technologies to strengthen its operational capabilities. “The Indian Navy is well set on a course of capability enhancement and modernisation. It shall be my endeavour to sustain the growth momentum, consolidate ongoing programmes and sharpen our operational capabilities,” he added.

Commissioned into the Indian Navy on July 1, 1987, Admiral Swaminathan is a Communication and Electronic Warfare specialist with nearly four decades of distinguished service.

During his career, he has held several key operational and staff appointments, including Commander of Western Fleet, Vice Chief of Naval Staff and Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief of Western Naval Command, a position he held prior to becoming the Navy chief.

Punjab and Haryana HC suspends ex-CBI court special judge

Press Trust of India
CHANDIGARH

The Punjab and Haryana High Court has suspended with immediate effect judicial officer Rajeev Goyal, the former Panchkula CBI court special judge.

At the time of the suspension, he was posted as the additional district and sessions judge, Kaithal.

The suspension order did not specify any reason, though it indicates that it pertains to the period when Mr. Goyal was posted as special judge in the CBI court.

The May 29 order, issued by the court’s Registrar General, states: “Hon’ble Chief Justice and judges, in exercise of powers under Article 235 of the Constitution of India read

with Rule 4 (b) of the Haryana Civil Services (Punishment and Appeal), Rules, 2016... to place Sh. Rajeev Goyal, the then special judge, CBI Court, Panchkula (now posted as additional district and sessions judge, Kaithal) under suspension with immediate effect in contemplation of initiation of disciplinary proceedings against the officer.”

“During the period of suspension, the headquarters of Sh. Rajeev Goyal will be at Kaithal. He will not leave the headquarters during this period without the prior permission of the district and sessions Judge, Kaithal...,” reads the order.

Mr. Goyal was transferred to Kaithal as additional district and sessions judge over a month ago.

3 detained in Kashmir while trying to cross into Pakistan

The Hindu Bureau
SRINAGAR



High vigil: Army soldiers patrol along the Line of Control between Pakistan and India in Uri Sector, Jammu and Kashmir. IMRAN NISSAR

Three local people who were trying to cross into Pakistan were arrested near the Line of Control (LoC) in Baramulla district in north Kashmir on Sunday.

An Army spokesperson said two local youth were trying to exfiltrate from the Uri sector into Pakistan-occupied Kashmir. Their guide, a former Territorial Army jawan, was also apprehended.

“They were captured after a search operation was launched in the general area of Uri following specific intelligence inputs. Two people from Sopore were apprehended by troops while allegedly attempting to exfiltrate through the Uri sector along with their guide,” said the spokesper-

son. The Army added that a probe was under way.

Intruder held

The Army, in a separate operation, arrested an intruder from PoK who was intercepted while crossing the LoC in Uri.

“Vigilant troops maintained restraint while challenging and apprehending the intruder. He has been handed over to the Jammu

and Kashmir Police,” the Army said in a statement.

The man, identified as Zeeshan Ahmad Mir, a resident of Painkadi village in Muzaffarabad, allegedly intended to meet a local girl, Iram Bano, a resident of Ti-lawari, Uri. She was detained near the Silkote area of Uri. “Both are being questioned,” officials said. Officials said a love affair cannot be ruled out.

Power Minister tells Bengal departments to clear dues

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

During his recent visit to West Bengal, Union Minister for Power Manohar Lal Khattar called upon several government departments of the State to clear their pending dues. Mr. Lal also sought their transition to prepaid meters, sources said. To alleviate the pressure on discoms (distribution companies), Mr. Lal also sought a “robust mechanism” for regular settlement of dues.

Reviewing the progress of ‘smart metering’, Mr. Lal called for its expeditious implementation. The State is committed to saturating establishments with smart meters by June, and in the prepaid mode by August, sources said.



BJP wins 3 of 4 Himachal civic bodies, Congress retains one

In a major jolt to the Congress, the BJP won Mandi, Dharamshala and Solan municipal corporation elections, while the ruling party managed to retain its mandate in the Palampur civic body. The BJP termed the election outcome a “public referendum” in favour of the saffron party. However, Congress leader Naresh Chauhan said the polls involving about 15% of the State’s electorate could not determine the broader public mandate. The elections to the four urban local bodies were held on May 17, and the results were declared on Sunday. The contest assumed significance as Himachal Pradesh is headed for Assembly polls due in 2027. PTI

CUET-UG 2026 exam held smoothly across centres

The rescheduled Common University Entrance Test-Undergraduate (CUET-UG) was conducted smoothly on Sunday across hundreds of examination centres after certain tests scheduled for May 28 were postponed due to Id, an NTA source said. The National Testing Agency (NTA) conducted the rescheduled CUET-UG 2026 examination in two shifts at centres across the country and overseas. The smooth conduct of the examination comes a day after a technical glitch at some centres delayed the start of Shift-I of the CUET-UG 2026. The NTA later announced a re-examination for 3,765 affected candidates.

Doval holds talks with Myanmar President

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

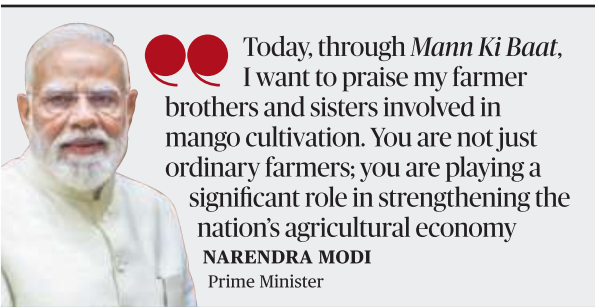
National Security Adviser Ajit Doval on Sunday met Myanmar’s President U Min Aung Hlaing and discussed key issues relating to bilateral ties. Mr. Hlaing, who is on a five-day trip to India, is scheduled to hold wide-ranging talks with Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday, focusing on ramping up ties in trade, connectivity, border security and defence. Mr. Hlaing’s visit to India comes less than two months after he became the President following Myanmar’s parliamentary elections. The elections were held in December and January, after years of protests against the ruling military-junta that seized power in a coup on February 1, 2021, overthrowing the democratically elected government of Aung San Suu Kyi. Myanmar is one of India’s strategic neighbours and shares a 1,640-kilometre-long border with a number of northeastern States, including militancy-hit Nagaland and Manipur. Mr. Hlaing will also travel to Mumbai on June 2 for business interactions.

Mann Ki Baat: PM praises athletes, changemakers

He praised Indian sprinters Gurindervir Singh and Animesh Kujur; lauded mango farmers for reaching global markets; shared story of educator Girija Amma for raising funds for soldiers

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi, in the 134th episode of *Mann Ki Baat* on Sunday, highlighted India’s achievements in sports, environmental conservation, cultural heritage, and scientific learning, while urging citizens to continue contributing towards nation-building through innovation, community participation, and social responsibility. A major highlight of the address was the Prime Minister’s praise for Indian sprinters Gurindervir Singh and Animesh Kujur, who delivered historic performances at the Federation Cup in Ranchi. During a telephone interaction with the athletes, Mr. Modi lauded their dedication and the spirit of healthy competition that has helped elevate Indian athletics. Mr. Singh recently became India’s fastest man after clocking a remarkable 10.09 seconds in the 100-metre sprint, becoming the first Indian athlete to



break the 10.10-second barrier.

Praising mango farmers Speaking about the summer season, Mr. Modi said mangoes remain an inseparable part of Indian households and culture. He praised farmers engaged in mango cultivation and highlighted how Indian mangoes are increasingly reaching global markets. “Today, through *Mann Ki Baat*, I want to praise my farmer brothers and sisters involved in mango cultivation. You are not just ordinary farmers; you are playing a significant role in strengthening the nation’s agricultural economy,” the Prime Minister said. Reflecting on his recent visit to the Netherlands, the Prime Minister described it as a significant step in strengthening India’s international partnerships. He also spoke about the return of rare Chola-era copper plates by the country, describing them as invaluable historical treasures that offer insights into the maritime strength, governance, and international relations of the Chola empire. Mr. Modi also underlined the importance of environmental conservation and highlighted efforts to protect the endangered Ganga river dolphin. He called upon citizens to actively participate in preserving biodiversity and natural ecosystems. The Prime Minister urged people and local ad-

ministrations to remain vigilant during heatwaves and work collectively to minimise their impact. He also appreciated grassroots initiatives such as the work of Saji Valasheeril in Kerala, who has trained thousands of people, including children with disabilities, through swimming programmes.

Astronomy initiatives Encouraging scientific curiosity among young people, Mr. Modi highlighted astronomy outreach initiatives by organisations such as Astro Kerala, the Bangalore Astronomical Society, and the Big Bang Astronomy Club of Rajkot. He said astronomy has long fascinated Indians and can inspire the next generation of scientists and innovators. The Prime Minister concluded by sharing the inspiring story of educator Girija Amma, whose initiative of collecting one rupee daily from students for soldiers raised nearly ₹40 lakh, calling it a shining example of patriotism and collective responsibility towards the nation.

U.K. Foreign Secretary to visit India and China for talks

Press Trust of India
LONDON

U.K. Foreign Secretary Yvette Cooper will travel to China on Monday before a visit to India on a two-nation tour focused on tackling global challenges and bolstering cooperation. The Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office (FCDO) said the ministerial engagements with the two major powers are expected to cover the situation in the Strait of Hormuz, Russia’s invasion of Ukraine and the Ebola outbreak in Africa. Ms. Cooper is scheduled to hold bilateral talks with External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar on Thursday, followed by interactions across business and academia. “The Foreign Secretary will be in India, where she will meet External Affairs Minister Dr. S. Jaishankar and entrepreneurs, academics and government partners who are delivering on the U.K.-India Vision 2035,” the FCDO said. Her visit to Delhi comes nearly a year after the bilateral Free Trade Agreement was signed off by Prime Minister Narendra Modi and his U.K. counterpart, Keir Starmer, last July.

Human trafficking can’t be separated from broader migration flows, says SC

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court has drawn a close link between migration and human trafficking, which it described as one of the worst forms of human exploitation. A journey in search of dignified livelihood often descends into a nightmare, mostly for women, and even children, the court said. A Bench of Justices J.B. Pardiwala and R. Mahadevan highlighted how “systemic inequalities transform a survival strategy into a pathway of exploitation”. While not all migration was trafficking, the latter phenomenon rarely occurred in the absence of migration, the court said. “For a large majority of this country’s population, migration is a survival and livelihood strategy; the structural vulnerabilities that drive such movement

“For a large majority of the population, migration is a survival and livelihood strategy”

also create conditions conducive to coercion and deception... Trafficking cannot be separated from broader migration flows. Rather, it emerges from within them,” Justice Pardiwala said in a 297-page judgment pronounced on May 29, and released during the weekend. The judgment further addressed the Immoral Traffic (Prevention) Act or the ITPA’s failure to accord rights and protections to voluntary adult sex workers. The silence of the statute, Justice Pardiwala observed, had only made the deep social stigma against them louder. This, the court said, had resulted in voluntary adult sex workers being isolated, marginalised, and unable to access protections that the law otherwise extends to them. It said a meaningful starting point would be for the government to recognise the rights of voluntary adult sex workers and provide them adequate protections. “The rights of sex workers can exist without there being a right to sex work,” Justice Pardiwala wrote. The court flagged the need for the Union government to re-examine the conflation between sex trafficking and sex work in the legislative framework. It said Section 143 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita requires that for an act of sexual exploitation to amount to trafficking, it has to fulfil the three-tiered framework of act, means, and purpose of the Palermo Protocol. But, on the other hand, all sex work was treated as trafficking under the ITPA. Section

143 mandates that the “act of bringing a person towards prostitution must have been done through one of the specified ‘means’, such as force, coercion, inducement, or deception, for it to constitute trafficking... The ITPA, on the other hand, operates on a fundamentally different logic. The ITPA requires no such ‘means’... Under the ITPA, all prostitution involving third parties is, in effect, treated as trafficking for commercial sexual exploitation, regardless of whether any force, coercion, or inducement was employed”, the court pointed out. The court also highlighted that the ITPA tends to harass the very victims it was meant to protect. Moreover, the Act does not expressly exclude children from its ambit. Both these factors must be looked into by the legislature, Justice Pardiwala said.

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BJP to host team of Nepal ruling party in an outreach to Balendra government

Nistula Hebbar
NEW DELHI

A five-member delegation of Nepal’s ruling party, the Rastriya Swatantra Party (RSP), under the leadership of its chairperson, Rabi Lamichhane, will visit India from Monday at the specific invitation of BJP president Nitin Nabin. A statement released by the BJP giving out details of this visit said Mr. Lamichhane and the delegation would visit the party headquarters and hold meeting with Mr. Nabin and senior BJP leaders. The visit assumes significance as it comes days after the cancellation of Indian Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri’s proposed visit to Kathmandu. It is believed that Mr. Misri, who was due to visit Nepal on May 12, cancelled his visit after no assurance was



forthcoming over a meeting with Nepal’s Prime Minister Balendra Shah. The meeting between the two ruling parties of India and Nepal therefore is being viewed as an effort to increase the political conversation between New Delhi and Kathmandu. “The visit seeks to initiate party-to-party engagement between the RSP and the BJP and provide an opportunity for exchange of views on organisational practices, democratic processes, and people-centric political outreach,” the BJP release said, adding that the party looked forward to a “constructive dialogue”. Mr. Lamichhane will also be making a personal visit to Ayodhya, the RSP said in a statement. The other members of the delegation are Bipin Kumar Acharya (joint general secretary of RSP and member of the House of Representatives), Deepak Bohora (secretariat member and member of the House of Representatives), Nikita Poudel, and Pradip Acharya. The visit also comes a day after Nepal Prime Minister Balendra Shah said that Nepal too had encroached upon some Indian territories, an unprecedented claim made by any Nepali government.

The Voice of Hind Rajab likely to get ‘A’ certificate

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Voice of Hind Rajab, the critically acclaimed 2025 film on the killing of the eponymous Palestinian five-year-old by Israeli forces, is set to be cleared by the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC) with an ‘A’ certificate, say official sources. This comes weeks after the Kaouthar Ben Hania directorial was rejected for supposedly being detrimental to India-Israel relations. The misgivings of the initial advisory panel drew censure from film-makers, actors, activists and the Opposition. For the film to release, the CBFC will have to issue the certificate on its website (a step yet to be completed), and hand over the certificate to the film distributor.

THE HINDU

CROSSWORD+ 14808

(set by Gridzilla)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at <https://thehindu.com/crosswords>

SCAN TO PLAY

1

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ACROSS

1. Cream is a baker's need, we hear (6)

4. Chapter out of Africa's wild expedition (6)

8. Taxes: they actually regulate imports from foreign soil, for starters (7)

9. Body builder banned from all contests? (7)

11. Worst place underground is mentioned in the Bible perhaps (10)

12. Cheese is arranged on the counter (4)

13. Upon reflection, will US omit invading city in Iraq? (5)

14. That's enough of kinky photos on sex (2,4,2)

16. Plant a kiss oddly on the mobile (8)

18. Small fish primarily found in river from the east (5)

20. Mount Washington's captivating! (4)

21. How to make the man say "We are the champions"? (4,6)

23. Study 'Introduction to Therapeutics' first, to become a doctor (7)

24. Let go and hire again (7)

25. Singular case, partly reviewed, is of lower back (6)

26. Fancy saree with a little red slip remover (6)

DOWN

1. Case of butter placed in empty fridge (5)

2. Without hesitation, runs to snort a bit of illicit drugs (7)

3. Reduces cost for American permits (9)

5. Shift is a key at the far ends of the typewriter (5)

6. Ogre ate bananas? Okay! (5,2)

7. Man-made reservation has no lake (9)

10. A weapon having little benefit? (9)

13. According to Spooner, to lock the dining room would be perfect (9)

15. Cry with hatred, as emotions initially go haywire (4,1,4)

17. Tight necktie almost chokes one on the move (7)

19. Pops down after scoring ecstasy (7)

21. Some fear a stalker...a dreaded one (5)

22. Belgian artist got high consuming narcotics primarily in retreat (5)

SUDOKU

		2	6		7		8	
		9		8				
5		1		4	2			
		7				4	3	
8								2
	3	5			8			
			4	1	7			6
				2	3			
1		9		6	5			

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★☆☆☆

Solution to previous puzzle

S	B	A	I
I	G	N	A
E	D	V	A
K	N	T	E
E	A	R	M
P	R	E	S
L	A	C	I
B	U	R	E
S	B	A	I
F	S	A	H
L	A	C	O
T	R	E	E
R	E	F	E
R	N	E	S

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

5	2	9	6	3	7	1	8	4
1	8	6	4	9	5	2	3	7
4	3	7	1	2	8	5	6	9
8	1	3	9	5	6	4	7	2
7	9	4	2	1	3	8	5	6
6	5	2	7	8	4	9	1	3
9	6	5	8	7	2	3	4	1
2	7	8	3	4	1	6	9	5
3	4	1	5	6	9	7	2	8

EDUCATIONPLUS

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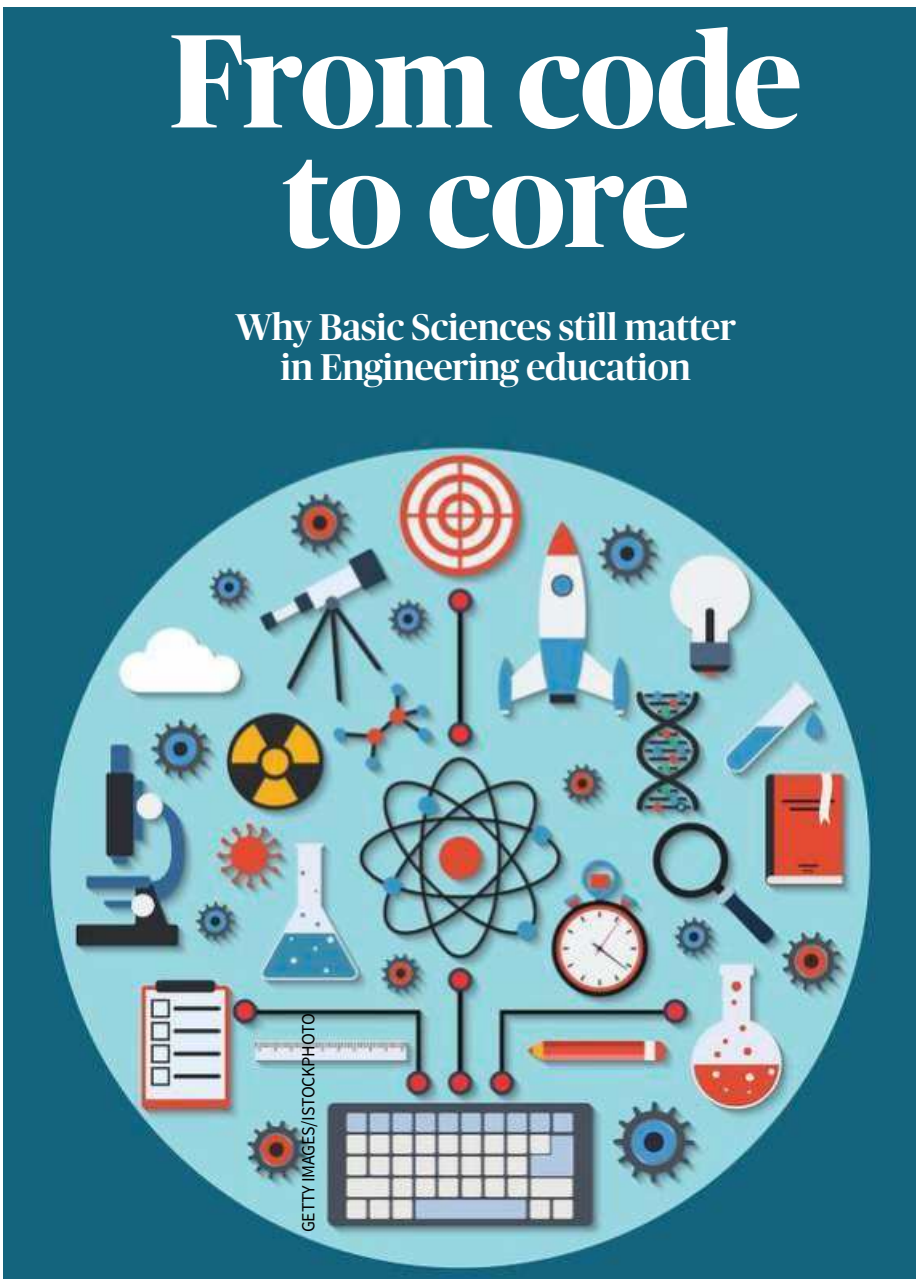
D. Praveen Sam

In many engineering colleges across India, a discernible curricular shift is underway; one that reflects not just pedagogical reform but also a deeper reordering of priorities. Courses such as Engineering Physics and Engineering Chemistry – long regarded as the intellectual bedrock of Engineering education – are being reduced, merged, or, in some instances, removed from the first-year curriculum.

This is driven largely by the growing dominance of programmes such as Computer Science Engineering, Information Technology, Artificial Intelligence, and Data Science, which are widely perceived as more immediately aligned with employability and industry demand, and equally shaped by student preference.

Placement-centric

Over the past decade, a substantial proportion of Engineering aspirants across India have gravitated toward computing-oriented disciplines, often assuming that Physics and Chemistry bear little relevance to careers in software development or data analytics. Such assumptions are further reinforced by placement-centric narratives that privilege short-term technical proficiency over conceptual depth. Yet this perception obscures a fundamental truth: Engineering, irrespective of its specialisation, remains anchored in the principles of basic science.



From code to core

Why Basic Sciences still matter in Engineering education

Engineering education, historically, has been structured upon a foundational triad of Physics, Chemistry, and Maths. This is particularly true of the formative first year, where conceptual clarity precedes specialisation. Earlier curriculum frame-

works positioned Engineering Physics and Engineering Chemistry at the beginning so that students could comprehend the behaviour of materials, energy, and systems. These courses introduced domains such as electromagnetic theory,

thermodynamics, optics, materials science, nanotechnology, and corrosion that underpin contemporary technological advancement. Their gradual dilution risks eroding the analytical rigour that distinguishes engineers from technicians. Engineers are

expected not merely to execute tasks, but also to analyse, design, and optimise systems through the application of scientific reasoning.

Untenable belief

The belief that Physics and Chemistry are relevant only to traditional “core” branches is increasingly untenable in an era of technological convergence. Semiconductor technology, which embeds the foundation of modern computing, is rooted in Solid-State Physics and Materials Chemistry. The design of microprocessors, memory systems, and communication networks depends on principles derived from quantum mechanics, electronic behaviour, and photonics.

Similarly, advances in energy-efficient computing and sustainable infrastructure draw upon Electrochemistry and Materials Science. Data centres, often perceived as abstract digital constructs, are intense physical environments governed by thermal dynamics and energy transfer. To perceive Computer Science as detached from the Physical Sciences is to overlook the very conditions that sustain digital technologies.

In a rapidly evolving technological ecosystem, the durability of scientific principles is crucial. Engineers grounded in these principles are better equipped to adapt, innovate, and interrogate underlying systems. An education that sidelines foundational science risks producing graduates who are vulnerable to techno-

logical obsolescence.

The growing emphasis on early specialisation further intensifies this concern. Students now commit to narrowly defined domains at the outset of their academic journey, often guided by market trends. While this may enhance immediate employability, it risks constraining intellectual rigour. Technological paradigms evolve rapidly, and skills that are currently in demand may soon lose their relevance.

A solid grounding in basic science equips engineers with the flexibility to cut across disciplines, engage with nascent fields, and be innovative. Many transformative developments, from quantum computing to nanotechnology, have emerged at

the intersection of Engineering and Fundamental Science, underscoring the importance of preserving this foundation.

The question, hence, is not whether Physics and Chemistry should be integral to Engineering curricula but how they need to reflect contemporary relevance. Integrating application-oriented modules offers a productive approach where the learners can relate to ideas learned and applied.

Physics can emphasise semiconductor devices, optical systems, and computational modelling, while Chemistry can focus on materials engineering, energy storage, corrosion prevention, and environmental sustainability. This will preserve conceptual

depth and enhance practical engagement.

As universities continue to recalibrate curricula, the marginalisation of Physics and Chemistry must be approached with caution. Their deletion will not merely streamline syllabi but weaken the very foundations of Engineering education and diminish the capacity for innovation. In the long arc of technological progress, what is required is not the abandonment of foundational knowledge but its renewal. Physics and Chemistry remain indispensable to the making of engineers who can design the future.

The writer is an Associate Professor of English at Sri Sivasubramaniya Nadar College of Engineering (SSN), Chennai.

Make an informed decision

Uncertain about your career options? Low on self-confidence? This column may help



OFF THE EDGE
Nandini Raman
I have completed Master's in Maths. When applying for jobs, I understood that my knowledge is only surface level despite my degree. I am planning an M.Tech Applied Math. What steps should I take to identify a suitable specialisation? Rose

What you are feeling is common. For M.Tech. Applied Math, work on computational skills to test theories on real data. Learn a programming language like Python and libraries like NumPy, SciPy, Pandas, and Matplotlib. Depending on your interest, familiarise yourself with MATLAB (for control systems/engineering), R (for heavy statistics), or C++ (for high-frequency trading).

Explore specialised software and take subjects that you enjoyed during your Master's and explore their direct industry applications. Replicate Applied Maths research papers by using Python or MATLAB.

Look at the curriculum for M.Tech programmes in Applied Maths, Industrial Maths, or Data Science at top institutions and check out prerequisites, the profiles of the faculty and their research topics. If a topic sounds fascinating, read their introductory papers and try to get an audience with them.

I am a B.Sc. Nursing graduate and have got a job too. I plan to attempt the UPSC CSE in 2029. How can I manage the preparation and my job? Ameya

Dear Ameya,
You can comfortably manage a full-time job

without burning out, provided you are disciplined and consistent. Nursing is physically and emotionally demanding, with rotating shifts. So try and follow a flexible study routine. Three hours a day is more than enough now. Study before your shift, as energy levels will be high. Use the time after your shift for lighter tasks like reading the newspaper, watching a news debate or revision. Do 6-8 hours on your off days.

NCERT textbooks of History, Geography, Polity/Civics, Economics and Science from Classes 6 to 12 are important. Use the ‘Two-Read’ Rule. Read 1: Read it like a storybook. Do not highlight. Do not make notes. Read 2: Read with a pencil, linking the chapters to the UPSC syllabus. Slowly move to standard textbooks and finalise your Optional Subject in year two. Consider weekend or online coaching in year three. Dedicate years four and five to ethics and writing practise for the Mains.

I am a B.Tech Electronics graduate who has a software job. I am considering an MBA. How can I find something that aligns with my interests? Adarsh

Dear Adarsh,
Meet a career counsellor and get a personality and career mapping done to understand your interests first. Explore MBA specialisations accordingly. Since you already have a software job, consider Product Management (PM). Try to shadow a Project Manager or a Business Analyst to see if the role interests you. Before committing to the CAT, GMAT, or GRE, reach out to your B.Tech friends who have done an MBA and ask about the reality of their jobs. Take free introductory courses in

Marketing or Financial Accounting on Coursera or LinkedIn Learning to help you make an informed decision.

After my UG in Electronics and Communication Engineering, I have been working as an Infrastructure Engineer. I want to pursue a Master's in the same field, but focusing on acoustics. I am primarily looking at countries such as Germany or Italy. What is the best approach to identify and apply to

programmes? Madhu

Dear Madhu,
Identify your interest: is it Architectural Acoustics (designing concert halls), Audio Engineering (music technology), or Industrial/Automotive Acoustics (reducing engine noise)? Some good German universities are the Technical University of Berlin, RWTH Aachen, TU Dresden and the University of Applied Sciences (TH) Lübeck.

Public universities in Italy have tuition fees based on your family income (ISEE-I equivalent). Look up the Politecnico di Milano (PoliMi), the University of Ferrara, and the University of Parma. You need to prove that

your ECE background satisfies their Acoustics prerequisites. Admissions committees will look for specific ECTS (credits) in your UG transcript. Most PG programmes are in English, but you will still need an IELTS (6.5+) or TOEFL score. For Germany, you will also need an APS certificate from the Academic Evaluation Centre before applying for a visa. This can take 2-4 months, so start early.

Disclaimer: This column is merely a guiding voice and provides advice and suggestions on education and careers.

The writer is a practising counsellor and a trainer. Send your questions to eduplus.thehindu@gmail.com with the subject line Off the Edge



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- B.Sc. Physics
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- M.Sc. Chemistry
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Home loan benefits for women

Santosh Agarwal

The lending ecosystem - banks/HFCs, regulator and the Government - have over the last decade unveiled several sops to encourage the participation of women borrowers in formal credit, particularly in home ownership. From preferential interest rates to tax and stamp duty benefits, these sops can significantly boost affordability and make home loan journey more advantageous for women borrowers and households.

Being aware and understanding the benefits on offer, however, is key.

Relatively lower rates

Interest rate concession on home loans is the most significant benefit for women borrowers. Many lenders usually offer a concession of 5-10 bps on interest rates to women, saving substantially over the loan tenure. Note, even a slight cut in interest rates can save lakhs in total loan cost, thereby, increasing loan affordability.

For instance, taking advantage of a 5 bps concession on a ₹50 lakh loan at 8.45% interest rate from SBI for 30 years, women borrowers can save about ₹63,632 in total interest cost.

Reduced stamp duty charges

Many State governments have cut stamp duty charges for women resulting in huge savings, especially for high-value properties. States, including UP, Haryana, Maharashtra and Delhi levy 1%-2% lower stamp duty on such loans compared to men, thereby encouraging more women to become property owners.

A woman borrower from Delhi can get a concession of up to ₹1 lakh on the property value of ₹50 lakh.

Tax benefits fully applicable

Borrowers continue to avail tax sops offered by the Income Tax Department under the old tax regime. A deduction of up to ₹1.5 lakh can be claimed under Sec. 80C for the principal paid and up to ₹2 lakh on the interest paid under Sec. 24(b). For joint loans – for instance by spouses – benefits can be claimed individually, enhancing total tax savings.

Subsidy under PMAY 2.0

Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojna (PMAY) provides special benefits to women, promoting home ownership, financial independence and long-term security. Under PMAY 2.0, female ownership is encouraged and in categories such as EWS and LIG having woman co-owner is mandatory to avail benefits.

As proposed in 2026, eligible borrowers can get subsidies of up to ₹1.80 lakh resulting in lower EMIs and reduced interest cost.

Better chances of loan approval

A woman borrower applying jointly with the spouse or a family member not only boosts loan eligibility but also raises loan-approval chances. This works well if the woman is an earning member contributing to household income. Dual income households are seen as lower risk by the lenders. Note, the woman co-borrower should also be the co-owner of the property.

Improved creditworthiness

Owning a property via home loan not only gives long-term financial security to women but also builds their credit profile. This makes it easier for them to access credit in the future on better terms. Lower EMIs, as a result of women co- or sole borrowers boost loan affordability and cut chances of missing repayments. This reduces the instances of default thereby improving creditworthiness.

Navigating smoothly

While several benefits make the loans more accessible for women, informed decision-making is critical. From comparing offers, understanding eligibility, checking EMI affordability to being aware of tax and other benefits can help maximise savings.

As more women emerge as primary borrowers and asset owners, they would play a crucial role in expanding the home-loan market and building inclusiveness.

(The writer is CEO, Paisabazaar)

Send queries on personal finance and investing to the moneywise@thehindu.co.in ID. Our experts in personal finance will respond to select queries, but will not give specific recommendations for investment in a particular mutual fund, share or fixed deposit.



ILLUSTRATION- SAAI

The prisoner who builds his own cell

Cave grows grander, yet Man Midas does not realise he is wearing golden handcuffs; he earns, spends more; in the endless game of lifestyle upgrades, he stops living, begins merely maintaining

GOLDEN HANDCUFFS

Vaishali R. Venkat

Days pass, but Man Midas never finds peace. The cave's grandeur that once was his pride, fills him with dread. What was once a dream has transformed into a burden he can no longer carry easily. Every possession needs upkeep, every upgrade adds another brick to the invisible walls trapping him inside and every sunrise carries an anxiety: what if it all collapses? Midas runs harder simply to stand in the same place.

After observing Midas in silence, Alien Aurum turns to Monk Moneywise and murmurs, “Midas no longer builds a life. He looks like a prisoner, trapped inside the very cage he built.”

Monk Moneywise nods, “True Aurum, the trap begins when humans expand standard of living, blurring the line between need and luxury. Extravagance becomes ordinary and options necessities. A cycle turns into a bike which evolves into a small car to finally mature as a sedan.”

“With each upgrade, fuel cost, insurance premia and EMIs multiply quietly. Bigger homes turn bigger EMIs, posh schools bring higher fee, club memberships bills, household help is the norm, foreign holidays are rituals. Comfort slowly hardens into financial obligation. Though Midas’ income rises, even one interruption in earn-

“Humans often stay trapped in lives that no longer bring joy because leaving feels like erasing every sacrifice once made to build them”

ings now threatens the entire life built around it.”

Alien Aurum asks in bewilderment, "Mr. Moneywise, if a family of two needs just a small place to eat and sleep, why do they spend entire lives paying for four or five big rooms?"

Imagined future

Gazing towards the distant human dwellings, Monk Moneywise whispers, “Homes disclose some of the deepest truths about human life. Humans build houses not just for today, but for imagined futures: visiting relatives, children who may settle abroad, grandchildren who may never arrive, prestige and the deep fear of appearing small before the society. The tragedy is rarely the size of the house, but the weight of the imagined future they purchase along with it.”

Alien Aurum interrupts, “Weight of the imagined future?”

Nodding gently, the monk explains, “Humans spend decades buying a house believing one day they will finally be relieved of monthly rental burdens. Yet, the irony shows itself years later. For instance, in the gated communities,

“Whether apartment is lived in or empty sans tenants, maintenance costs keep rising every month, often running into several thousands.”

Even after fully owning the flat, charges never truly stop. Whether the apartment is lived in, locked for months, or empty without tenants for years, maintenance charges continue arriving month on month, often running into several thousands. The tragedy deepens further with age.”

Alien Aurum cuts in and asks Monk Moneywise, “The tragedy deepens with age? How?”

Mr. Moneywise continues, “Aurum, many elderly residents no longer regularly use the swimming pools, clubhouses or luxury amenities they once proudly paid for, yet the maintenance charges never disappear. During salaried years, these costs appear harmless. But after retirement, the shock slowly emerges. They now have to keep paying significant money monthly simply to continue living inside a house they already fully own but not fully use.”

Buried exhaustion

Years of buried exhaustion suddenly erupt through Midas. “Enough of your theories and sermons! It's been years of struggle and do you know what all I have sacrificed to build all

these? Missed family moments, sleepless nights, health slowly breaking down, dreams postponed and what not. It's easy for you to mock me. But how can I simply walk away? If I let go of this life, then what is all that pain even for? Every sleepless night and every sacrifice goes into bins? We cannot bleed for something our entire lives and then simply let it go.”

Now Master Time interrupts saying, "That pain you cannot let go of, Midas, has a name. Behavioural economists call it the sunk-cost fallacy: humans often stay trapped in lives that no longer bring joy because leaving feels like erasing every sacrifice once made to build them.”

Crucial questions

Time's voice echoes across the silent valley, “Before every upgrade ask yourself: Can I sustain this if my income falls? Will this matter to me ten years from now? Am I buying this for need or status? What are the recurring charges even after the excitement fades? Am I buying for the present life or the imagined future? Am I here because I want this life, or because leaving it now feels too costly? If Midas had asked these questions before every purchase, he would have built a life not a cage and the golden handcuffs would never have found a wrist to bind itself upon.”

(The writer is an NISM & CRISIL-certified Wealth Manager and certified in NISM’s Research Analyst module)

Gold dips, silver rises

PRECIOUS METALS

Both gold and silver are still range bound; while there can be a short-term bounce in the prices of the precious metals, there are no signs yet of any resumption of the longer-term uptrend

B. Krishnakumar

It was a mixed bag for precious metals in May. While gold prices lost sheen in May and slid to a 2-month low before recovering towards the end of the month, silver managed to hold ground. The uncertainty around the conflict in the Middle East had a key role in keeping precious metals price under check.

Comex gold closed 1.43% lower to \$4,569.9 by May end. Comex silver gained 1.8% to settle at \$75.58.

The performance of the metals in the local market was much better owing to weakening of the Rupee against the U.S. Dollar and the rise in the import duty on gold and silver.

MCX Gold gained 4.3% to ₹1,61,049 per 10-gram. MCX Silver closed on a positive note at ₹2,67,000 a kilogram, representing a 9.14% gain last month.

Comex gold price continues to oscillate within the extremes of the \$4,400-\$5,650 range. The price has consolidated for a while now and a trending move can start soon. Considering the medium to long term trend is still positive, an upside breakout is likely.

As long as Comex gold price sustains above \$4,310, expect a rally to immediate target of \$4,650-\$4,720. The next higher targets are at \$4,790-\$4,830. A drop below \$4,300 would warrant reassessment of the medium-term positive outlook.

Comex silver price too is stuck in \$71-\$90 range for the past few weeks. The long-term uptrend in silver would resume only after a breakout above \$92. Until then, expect volatile price action within the \$71-\$90 range.

As anticipated last month, MCX gold price touched the short-term target of ₹1,53,000-₹1,55,000. Except for a big spike post import duty hike, gold price was largely listless in the local market. The price is still confined within the broad range of ₹1,45,000-₹1,75,000. Only a breakout from this range would trigger the next big directional move in gold.

MCX silver price too spiked up post import duty hike but cooled off in the past few weeks. Though there is a possibility of the price heading to the short-term target of ₹2,80,000-₹2,80,500, expect a meaningful uptrend to resume only after a breakout above ₹3,10,000. A drop below ₹2,03,000 would weaken the medium-term outlook for silver.

Conclusion

Both gold and silver are still range bound while the long-term trend stays positive. While there can be a short-term bounce in precious metal prices, there are no signs yet of any resumption of longer-term uptrend.

(The author is a Chennai-based analyst/trader. Views and opinion here are based on an analysis of short-term price movements in gold and silver futures at COMEX & Multi Commodity Exchange of India. This is not meant to be a trading/investment advice.)

Bank Fixed Deposit Rates

Bank Name	Interest Rates (%)			
	Highest Slab	1-year Tenure	3-year Tenure	5-year Tenure
Small Finance Banks				
AU Small Finance Bank	7.25	6.35	7.25	6.75
Equitas Small Finance Bank	7.40	6.90	7.00	7.00
ESAF Small Finance Bank	7.75	4.75	6.00	5.75
Jana Small Finance Bank	8.11	7.00	7.50	7.77
Shivalik Small Finance Bank	7.80	6.00	6.75	6.25
slice Small Finance Bank	7.75	6.25	7.50	7.00
Suryoday Small Finance Bank	8.10	7.25	7.25	7.90
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	7.45	7.25	7.20	7.20
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	8.10	6.00	7.50	7.00
Private Sector Banks				
Axis Bank	6.45	6.25	6.45	6.45
Bandhan Bank	7.25	7.00	7.25	5.85
City Union Bank	7.00	6.50	6.50	6.25
CSB Bank	7.35	5.00	5.75	5.75
DBS Bank	6.85	6.30	6.40	6.25
DCB Bank	7.25	6.90	7.00	7.25
Federal Bank	6.75	6.25	6.75	6.40
HDFC Bank	6.50	6.25	6.45	6.40
ICICI Bank	6.50	6.25	6.45	6.50
IDFC FIRST Bank	7.25	6.50	7.25	7.15
Indusind Bank	7.00	6.75	6.90	6.65

Bank Name	Interest Rates (%)			
	Highest Slab	1-year Tenure	3-year Tenure	5-year Tenure
Public Sector Banks				
Jammu & Kashmir Bank	7.25	6.75	6.65	6.60
IDBI Bank	6.50	6.20	6.35	6.25
Karnataka Bank	6.75	6.50	6.15	6.15
Kotak Mahindra Bank	6.80	6.50	6.40	6.25
RBL Bank	7.20	7.00	7.20	6.70
SBM Bank India	7.30	7.10	7.10	7.00
South Indian Bank	6.80	6.25	6.20	5.70
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	7.25	6.80	6.70	6.70
YES Bank	7.00	6.65	7.00	6.75
Public Sector Banks				
Bank of Baroda	6.45	6.25	6.25	6.30
Bank of India	6.70	6.50	6.70	6.00
Bank of Maharashtra	6.65	6.20	5.25	5.00
Canara Bank	6.60	6.25	6.25	6.25
Central Bank of India	6.65	6.10	6.00	6.00
Indian Bank	6.60	6.10	6.05	6.00
Indian Overseas Bank	6.60	6.50	6.10	6.10
Punjab National Bank	6.60	6.25	6.30	6.10
Punjab & Sind Bank	6.75	5.85	5.85	5.95
State Bank of India	6.45	6.25	6.30	6.05
Union Bank of India	6.60	6.25	6.20	6.00

Home Loan Interest Rates

Name of Lender	Loan Amount (Rs.)		
	Upto 30 lakh	Above 30 lakh & upto 75 lakh	Above 75 lakh
(In %)			
Public Sector Banks			
State Bank of India	7.25-9.05	7.25-9.05	7.25-9.05
Bank of Baroda	7.20-9.00	7.20-9.00	7.20-9.05
Union Bank of India*	7.15-9.60	7.15-9.60	7.15-9.60
Punjab National Bank	7.25-9.25	7.20-9.15	7.20-9.15
Bank of India	7.10-10.00	7.10-10.00	7.10-10.25
Bank of Maharashtra	7.10-9.90	7.10-9.90	7.10-9.90
Punjab and Sind Bank	7.30-10.70	7.30-10.70	7.30-10.70
Indian Overseas Bank	7.10 #	7.10 #	7.10 #
Indian Bank	7.15-9.55	7.15-9.55	7.15-9.55
Central Bank of India	7.10-9.15	7.10-9.15	7.10-9.15
Private Sector Banks			
Kotak Mahindra Bank	7.60 #	7.60 #	7.60 #
ICICI Bank	7.50 #	7.50 #	7.50 #
Axis Bank	8.00-11.90	8.00-11.90	8.00 - 9.10
HSBC Bank	7.45 #	7.45 #	7.45 #
South Indian Bank	7.20 #	7.20 #	7.20 #
Karur Vysya Bank	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65
Karnataka Bank	7.31-11.69	7.31-11.69	7.31-11.69

Name of Lender	Loan Amount (Rs.)		
	Upto 30 lakh	Above 30 lakh & upto 75 lakh	Above 75 lakh
(In %)			
Housing Finance Companies (HFCs)			
Federal Bank	8.30 - 10.75	7.30 - 10.75	7.30 - 9.75
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	7.90 - 9.30	7.90 - 9.30	7.90 - 9.30
Bandhan Bank	8.41-13.38	8.41-13.38	8.41-13.38
RBL Bank	8.20 #	8.20 #	8.20 #
CSB Bank	8.30 #	8.30 #	8.30 #
HDFC Bank	7.75 #	7.75 #	7.75 #
City Union Bank	8.25-9.50	8.50-10.00	8.75-10.50
Housing Finance Companies (HFCs)			
LIC Housing Finance	7.15 #	7.15 #	7.15 #
Bajaj Housing Finance	7.25 #	7.25 #	7.25 #
Tata Capital	8.00 #	8.00 #	8.00 #
PNB Housing Finance	7.50 #	7.50 #	7.50 #
GIC Housing Finance	8.20 #	8.20 #	8.20 #
SMFG India Home Finance	9.35 #	9.35 #	9.35 #
Sammaan Capital	8.75 #	8.75 #	8.75 #
Aditya Birla Capital	7.75 #	7.75 #	7.75 #
ICICI Home Finance	7.50 #	7.50 #	7.50 #
Godrej Housing Finance	7.65 #	7.65 #	7.65 #
*Extra 0.05% concession to borrowers taking insurance policy Rates as on May 27 #onwards Source:Paisabazaar.com			

LOS ANGELES
U.S. chemical spill toll rises to 11 as rescuers find bodies of 9 missing



REUTERS
The death toll from a chemical spill at a paper plant in Washington state has risen to 11 as rescuers recovered the bodies of all nine missing people, U.S. authorities said on Saturday. A huge tank holding lakhs of litres of a highly caustic substance imploded on Tuesday at the plant in Longview, Washington state. AFP

PARIS
780 arrested, deadly road accident in riotous PSG victory celebrations



AFP
French authorities announced on Sunday that 780 people were arrested across the country when overnight celebrations of Paris Saint-Germain's Champions League victory over Arsenal were marred by violent clashes, and a road accident that killed a young man. Interior Minister said that 57 security forces were injured. AFP

BUCHAREST
Romania identifies drone behind apartment block strike as Russian



AFP
Further analysis of a drone that smashed into a Romanian apartment building, sparking furious condemnation of Russia, has shown that it undoubtedly came from Moscow's forces, Bucharest said on Sunday. "The drone that crashed Thursday in Galati is a Geran-2, of Russian origin," President Nicusor Dan said. AFP

CARACAS
Venezuela Opposition candidate who claimed 2024 win backs vote



AFP
Venezuela's Edmundo Gonzalez Urrutia, the Opposition candidate who was recognised by the United States and others as the actual winner of the 2024 election against Nicolas Maduro, called on Saturday for a new vote. The 76-year-old who is living in exile in Spain, also expressed support for Maria Corina Machado. AFP

Israel captures Beaufort castle in Lebanon in its deepest incursion

Defence Minister Katz says Israel will hold the site while targeting 'thousands more homes' and Hezbollah infrastructure in southern Lebanon; the 12th century Crusader-built castle overlooks Litani river and has long-standing strategic importance

Associated Press
BEIRUT

Israeli troops have captured a strategic mountain topped with a Crusader-built castle in southern Lebanon in the deepest incursion into the country in more than a quarter-century, the military said on Sunday.
The capture of Beaufort castle, near the city of Nabatiyeh, came after days of air strikes and intense fighting in nearby villages where Israeli troops fought Hezbollah members in the rugged area.
Its capture marks a major development in the latest Israel-Hezbollah war,



REUTERS
Holding down the fort: Israeli soldiers operate at Beaufort Ridge in southern Lebanon on Sunday. REUTERS

which began on March 2 when Hezbollah fired rockets into northern Israel two days after the U.S. and Israel attacked its main backer, Iran.

Defence Minister Israel Katz wrote on X that they raised an Israeli flag over the castle. Israeli troops previously captured the castle in 1982 and held it until they withdrew from Lebanon in 2000.
"Twenty six years after the withdrawal from the security zone in Lebanon, the Israeli flag has returned to fly on the peaks that overlook the Galilee towns," Mr. Katz said at a memorial ceremony for Israeli soldiers killed in its previous occupation of southern Lebanon.
Mr. Katz said Israel intends to hold the castle as its troops work to destroy thousands more homes

that he says were used by Hezbollah and other military infrastructure in southern Lebanon.
The Beaufort fortress, perched high atop Lebanon's rolling green hills and overlooking the Litani River, has been a strategic military asset for centuries.
Built as a Crusader castle around the 12th century on top of previous fortifications, it has also been used by Saladin's Jerusalem army, Mamluks, Ottomans, the French mandate, the Palestine Liberation Organisation and the Israeli military until 2000, when it was partially restored and opened to visitors.



Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf

Iran's chief negotiator warned the United States is not to be trusted on Sunday, saying Tehran would not agree to any deal with Washington unless it fully secures Iranian rights.
Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf's remarks came as reports emerged that U.S. President Donald Trump had sent a tougher peace proposal back to Iran, and underlined the rift that the parties still need to close.
Any further tweaks to the draft could further delay an agreement to formally end the West Asia war and reopen the Strait of Hormuz after weeks of fraught negotiations marked by sharp rhetoric and occasional flare-ups of

ern allies have long suspected it aims to develop a weapon.
The New York Times and Axios reported on Saturday that Mr. Trump had sent back a "tougher" new framework to be considered by Iran, though details remain unclear.
Top priorities
Mr. Trump has said his priorities include stopping Iran from any nuclear weapon development and re-opening the Hormuz shipping lane, over which Iran has sought to impose control since the war began.
According to the Tasnim news agency, "exchanges between Iran and the U.S. regarding the text of a possible memorandum of understanding are ongoing, with both parties regularly proposing amendments.

Ukraine hits Russian energy sites, denies striking nuclear plant

Associated Press
KYIV

Ukraine denied Moscow's claims on Sunday that a Ukrainian drone struck the Russian-controlled Zaporizhzhia nuclear plant, as Kyiv launched fresh strikes overnight on Russian energy sites.
Ukraine's General Staff on Sunday said Ukrainian drones had struck the Saratov oil refinery in southwestern Russia, causing a "large-scale fire". It said the extent of the damage was being clarified, and claimed the refinery has been supplying Moscow's war effort.
Kyiv denied a Russian claim that a Ukrainian



AFP
The Zaporizhzhia nuclear power plant in Russian-held southern Ukraine. AFP

drone struck the Zaporizhzhia nuclear plant, Europe's largest.
Russia's state nuclear energy company, Rosatom, said on Saturday that the drone exploded after tearing a hole in the wall of a turbine hall, and accused Ukraine of a "deliberate" attack.

U.S. to send only used subs to Australia in revised defence deal

Agence France-Presse
SINGAPORE

Australia will only receive used nuclear-powered submarines from the United States as part of an agreement to "streamline" the AUKUS deal, with the move branded on Sunday as a "cost-effective" measure by Defence Minister Richard Marles.
The two nations – together with the third partner in their security pact, Britain – met at Singapore's Shangri-La Dialogue, which brings together top defence officials and experts from about 45 countries.
Under the 2021 AUKUS deal, Australia is expected

to receive at least three so-called "Virginia-class" nuclear-powered submarines from the United States within 15 years.
Australia had been expecting to receive two used submarines and one new one, but the countries announced on Saturday that all three will now be in-service vessels from the U.S. Navy stock.
When asked why Canberra was now receiving only used equipment, Mr. Marles, who is also Deputy Prime Minister, told presspersons on Sunday it would be more cost-effective. In a joint statement, the U.S. and the U.K. confirmed the revision to the submarine agreement.

Japan's Defence Minister takes veiled swipe at China at Shangri-La summit

Agence France-Presse
SINGAPORE

Japan's Defence Minister took a veiled swipe at China on Sunday, pledging to keep strengthening the military despite Beijing's criticism of Tokyo's increasingly muscular security stance.
Under Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi, Japan has quickened its pivot towards a more proactive defence policy, further shaking off – with U.S. encouragement – a pacifist outlook in place since the end of the Second World War. The change has drawn frequent rebukes from Beijing, which has accused Tokyo of following a reckless policy of "new



REUTERS
Shinjiro Koizumi, Japan's Defence Minister, speaks at the Shangri-La Dialogue security summit in Singapore on Sunday. REUTERS

militarism" that could destabilise the region.
Japanese Defence Minister Shinjiro Koizumi hit back on Sunday, saying "nothing could be further from the truth".
"Think about it. There is a country that has a huge

arsenal of nuclear weapons and strategic bombers," Mr. Koizumi said at the annual IISS Shangri-La Dialogue in Singapore.
"Japan has neither of such weapons. And yet, Japan is labelled [as] 'new militarism'. Isn't it

strange?" he said, without mentioning China by name.
China is thought to possess hundreds of nuclear warheads and has been rapidly developing its military in recent years.
A diplomatic spat between the Asian rivals has been rumbling since Ms. Takaichi suggested in November that Japan might intervene militarily if China were to attempt to seize Taiwan, the self-ruled island that Beijing claims is part of its territory.
Mr. Koizumi said that China was expanding its military capabilities "without sufficient transparency" and that its military activities were "a matter of serious concern for Japan".

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STELLAR SHOW

Bhuvneshwar equals Shami's mark with 28 wickets in a season



K.R. DEEPAK

With 28 wickets to his name, Bhuvneshwar Kumar equalled Mohammed Shami (GT in 2023) to be second on the list of Indian bowlers with the most wickets in one edition of the IPL. Harshal Patel (32 wickets for RCB in 2021) tops the chart. Bhuvneshwar finished with an average of 17.89 and an economy rate of 7.95.

CONSCIOUS EFFORT

We refrained from talking about defending the title, says Karthik



VIJAY SONEJI

We wanted to keep pushing towards our second title. One thing that we refrained from using was language around defending our title. Instead, we spoke about trying to win our second title. I think that it has made a big difference — Dinesh Karthik, batting coach and mentor of Royal Challengers Bengaluru.

TRUE CHAMPION

Evergreen Kohli second oldest to win PoM award in IPL final



VIJAY SONEJI

At the age of 37 years and 207 days, Virat Kohli became the second oldest player to win the Player-of-the-Match award in an Indian Premier League final. Anil Kumble (38y 219d, 4-0-16-4 for Royal Challengers Bengaluru vs. Deccan Chargers in 2009) remains the oldest recipient of the award.

PRODIGY

15-year-old Sooryavanshi the youngest to clinch Orange Cap



IPLT20.COM

Rajasthan Royals opener Vaibhav Sooryavanshi became the youngest player to clinch the IPL Orange Cap. The 15-year-old amassed 776 runs (one century and five half-centuries) in 16 innings to walk home with the prize. Gujarat Titans' Shubman Gill and Sai Sudharsan were in contention but fell for low scores in the final.



Ruthless: Royal Challengers capped a memorable campaign with an emphatic win in the grand finale. Patidar & Co. saved their best for the last and dashed Titans' hopes of regaining the crown. K.R. DEEPAK

Royal Challengers retain title with a regal display

Kohli takes the Bengaluru side home with an unbeaten 75; the bowlers restrict Titans to 155 for eight after Patidar asks them to take first strike; Washington wages a lone battle for Gill's men

IPL-19

Ashwin Achal
AHMEDABAD

Royal Challengers Bengaluru crowned a dominant IPL 2026 campaign with a crushing five-wicket victory over Gujarat Titans in the final here on Sunday, sealing the title with the same authority it had shown through the season.

RCB had set the standard from the opening weeks of the tournament, and reserved its best for the biggest night.

For a side considered favourite, the season ended in fitting fashion – as champion for the second successive year.

The RCB bowlers set the tone early at the Narendra Modi Stadium, relentlessly hitting hard lengths to strangle GT. A sub-par 155 for eight was never likely to be enough to seriously test a power-packed RCB batting line-up.

Stark contrast That gulf in intent was evident when Virat Kohli (75 n.o., 42b, 9x4, 3x6) and Venkatesh Iyer (32, 16b, 4x4, 2x6) came out attacking, in stark contrast to GT's muddled innings. The pair took on Mohammed Siraj and Kagiso Rabada, powering RCB to 70 for two in the PowerPlay.

With the required rate dropping to 6.14, GT was left to play catch up.

Rashid Khan briefly raised hopes when he dismissed Rajat Patidar and Krunal Pandya in the ninth over, but with Kohli still around, RCB remained in control.

RCB capped a memorable campaign in emphatic fashion, crossing the line with 12 balls to spare. The 90,000-odd crowd, with RCB jerseys in the majority, erupted as Kohli launched Arshad Khan into the sky.

Patidar's decision to field first was vindicated,



Delivering on the big night: Rasikh was the most successful RCB bowler while Hazlewood picked up a couple before the RCB openers Venkatesh and Kohli came out swinging. K.R. DEEPAK & VIJAY SONEJI

as GT never quite found room to breathe.

After the RCB pacers struck early, left-arm spinner Krunal tightened the grip with subtle changes of pace and trajectory.

Only Washington Sundar escaped the choke-



hold. His unbeaten 50 (37b, 5x4) was an innings of resistance, but it was a lone hand in a line-up that never settled.

Shubman Gill's men appeared wary of RCB's pace attack from the outset. Intent gave way to preserva-

tion, and preservation soon became paralysis.

Introduced in the third over, Josh Hazlewood moved Gill with a length ball. Sai Sudharsan followed soon after, miscuing while attempting to hook Bhuvneshwar Kumar. With

SCOREBOARD

GUJARAT TITANS

Sai Sudharsan c Jitesh b Bhuvneshwar 12 (12b, 2x4), Shubman Gill c Patidar b Hazlewood 10 (8b, 2x4), Nishant Sindhu c Padikkal b Rasikh 20 (18b, 3x4), Jos Buttler st. Jitesh b Krunal 19 (23b, 1x4), Washington Sundar (not out) 50 (37b, 5x4), Arshad Khan c Rasikh b Hazlewood 15 (6b, 2x6), Rahul Tewatia c Patidar b Rasikh 7 (5b, 1x4), Jason Holder c Hazlewood b Bhuvneshwar 7 (5b, 1x4), Rashid Khan c Shepherd b Rasikh 7 (3b, 1x6), Kagiso Rabada (not out) 3 (3b); Extras (lb-1, w-4): 5; Total (for eight wks. in 20 overs): 155.

FALL OF WICKETS

1-22 (Gill, 2.2 overs), 2-26 (Sai Sudharsan, 3.4), 3-55 (Nishant, 7.6), 4-73 (Buttler, 12.1), 5-99 (Arshad, 14.1), 6-115 (Tewatia, 16.1), 7-142 (Holder, 18.3), 8-151 (Rashid, 19.2).

RCB BOWLING

Duffy 4-0-38-0, Bhuvneshwar 4-0-29-2, Hazlewood 4-0-37-2,

Rasikh 4-0-27-3, Krunal 4-0-23-1.

ROYAL CHALLENGERS

Venkatesh Iyer (Impact Player for Duffy) c Rabada b Siraj 32 (16b, 4x4, 2x6), Virat Kohli (not out) 75 (42b, 9x4, 3x6), Devdutt Padikkal c Arshad b Rabada 1 (4b), Rajat Patidar c Rabada b Rashid 15 (13b, 1x4, 1x6), Krunal Pandya lbw b Rashid 1 (2b), Tim David c Buttler b Arshad 24 (17b, 3x4, 1x6), Jitesh Sharma (not out) 11 (14b, 1x4); Extras (lb-1, w-1): 2; Total (for five wks. in 18 overs): 161.

FALL OF WICKETS

1-62 (Venkatesh, 4.3), 2-63 (Padikkal, 5.1), 3-89 (Patidar, 8.2), 4-91 (Krunal, 8.5), 5-132 (David, 13.6).

TITANS BOWLING

Siraj 4-0-36-1, Rabada 3-0-44-1, Holder 2-0-16-0, Rashid 4-0-25-2, Arshad 4-0-32-1, Prasidh (Impact Player for Tewatia) 1-0-7-0.

Toss: RCB; PoM: Kohli. RCB won by five wickets with two overs to spare.

Impact Index

3 RCB is the third team, after CSK and MI, to successfully defend its title

3 Kohli has the most scores of 75 or more in T20 finals

3.3 RCB's 50 is the fastest in a final. CSK (4 overs in 2023) held the previous record

4 Rabada (2020, 2026) is the fourth player to win the Purple Cap twice after Bravo (2013, 2015), Bhuvneshwar (2016, 2017) and Harshal (2021, 2024)

4 Patidar is the fourth skipper to win two or more titles after Dhoni (5), Rohit (5) and Gambhir (2)

9 For the ninth consecutive season, the winner of Qualifier 1 has gone on to lift the title. Overall, the record is 13 (out of 16) since the playoffs format was introduced in 2011

25 Kohli's quickest half-century (by balls faced) in the IPL

28 Patidar has taken the least matches by a captain to win two crowns (Rohit 44, Dhoni 59, Gambhir 79)

75 Kohli's is the second highest unbeaten score in a successful run chase in a final after Watson's 117 n.o. vs. SRH in 2018

Compiled by ANIRUDH VELAMURI

its two premier batters back in the pavilion inside four overs, GT retreated.

The promotion of Nishant Sindhu to No. 3 underlined the mood. Tasked with blunting the new ball, Sindhu could not shift momentum, and the move only strengthened RCB's control.

GT went nearly seven overs after the PowerPlay without a boundary. Jos Buttler, usually quick to change gears, crawled at under a run-a-ball. When

he finally tried to accelerate, Krunal outfoxed him with a quicker delivery and Jitesh Sharma did the rest.

Even the death overs brought little relief. Washington alone kept the scoreboard moving.

Lucky break

Dropped by substitute Jordan Cox on four, he dragged GT to a total that kept faint hope alive.

That hope vanished quickly once Kohli and Venkatesh came out to bat.

Composure of the guys just shone through: Kohli

Ashwin Achal
AHMEDABAD

At this very venue last year, Virat Kohli sunk to the ground and held back tears when Royal Challengers Bengaluru broke a long drought to clinch its maiden IPL trophy.

On Sunday, Kohli was far less emotional when RCB successfully defended the title. There was no novelty to celebrate this year, just the satisfaction of a thorough professional getting the job done.

Kohli was clinical with the bat, striking an unbeaten 42-ball 75 to lead the RCB chase.

His confidence reflected the feeling in a team which stayed ahead of the pack right from the early phase of the competition.

"It doesn't feel like the same pressure as last year. We knew what kind of ability we have in the group. We topped the table. There's a reason why we got here first. The skill sets we have, the maturity, the composure of the guys just shone through again tonight," Kohli said after the win.

RCB's excellent campaign had hinged on handy contributions from several members of the squad, a shift from the star-driven ethos in past teams.

"We have a group of guys where you don't need to be the one to step up every time. There are guys behind you, around you, who can win games. We have so many 'Player-of-the-Match' awards spread throughout the group. I feel so happy to play in a group where we have balance. We are an all-round strong team, and that is why we have confidence on the field," Kohli said.

Honours board

2008	Rajasthan Royals
2009	Deccan Chargers
2010	Chennai Super Kings
2011	Chennai Super Kings
2012	Kolkata Knight Riders
2013	Mumbai Indians
2014	Kolkata Knight Riders
2015	Mumbai Indians
2016	Sunrisers Hyderabad
2017	Mumbai Indians
2018	Chennai Super Kings
2019	Mumbai Indians
2020	Mumbai Indians
2021	Chennai Super Kings
2022	Gujarat Titans
2023	Chennai Super Kings
2024	Kolkata Knight Riders
2025	Royal Challengers Bengaluru
2026	Royal Challengers Bengaluru

... And the caps go to

Matches 16	Runs 776
ORANGE CAP Sooryavanshi (RR)	
HS: 103	SR: 237.30
Matches 17	Wickets 29
PURPLE CAP Rabada (GT)	
BB: 3/25	Econ: 9.68

Best on show Most Valuable Player: Vaibhav Sooryavanshi (RR); Orange Cap: Sooryavanshi; Purple Cap: Kagiso Rabada (GT); Emerging player: Sooryavanshi; Super striker (highest SR): Sooryavanshi; Most sixes: Sooryavanshi; Most fours: Sai Sudharsan (GT); Most dot balls: Mohammed Siraj (GT); Catch of the season: Manish Pandey (KKR); Fairplay: Punjab Kings

Divya snatches lead; Gukesh prevails over Pragg

Tari backs under-fire Gukesh to turn things around

Adithya and Rehan top among juniors; Shiv, Ayansh share honours in mini class

AROUND THE CITY



D'artagnan wins the feature event

LIVE TELECAST

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	PLAIN	CHOCOLATE												
CALORIES (KCAL)	128	130.2	348.5	133	138	225	107	108	107	57	68	272	241	
QUANTITY	32 g	34 g	205 g (DRAINED WEIGHT)	180 mL	200 mL	250 mL	200 mL	200 mL	200 mL	60 g	60 g	400 g	65 g	
PRICE (INR)	₹ 90 (PACK OF 10) ₹ 80 (PACK OF 30) ₹ 70 (PACK OF 60)	₹ 92 (PACK OF 10) ₹ 83.3 (PACK OF 30) ₹ 75 (PACK OF 60)	₹ 165	₹ 40	₹ 60	₹ 110	₹ 30	₹ 30	₹ 30	₹ 40	₹ 50	₹ 80	₹ 40 (PACK OF 30)	

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Tejaswin — a battler who embraces tough tests

Having become the first Indian to cross 8,000 points in decathlon, the 27-year-old is eyeing bigger things; he is open to the idea of competing in multiple events at the Glasgow Commonwealth Games

Y.B. Sarangi

Tejaswin Shankar, the National record holder in high jump and decathlon, loves to break barriers, especially the tougher ones. When he ruled the high jump scene in India, he chose to switch to the much tougher decathlon and put himself through harder tests. After becoming the first Indian to cross 8,000 points (8,057) in decathlon in the Federation athletics meet at the Birs Munda Stadium (Morabadi) in Ranchi, Tejaswin – an Asian Games silver medallist in decathlon and a high jump bronze winner at the Commonwealth Games – was relieved.

What made it possible Four personal bests (in 100m, long jump, 400m and 1500m) were achieved, courtesy a combination of factors – his sound knowledge of the disciplines, meticulous planning, hard work and support system. “The 8,000-point barrier is officially broken. No more worrying about wind or asterisks. I was very happy to achieve it because I had two chances this season. In heptathlon, I did 5,997, and that stung. Before that, my best was around 5,657. I knew I was in shape for 6,000. When you’re that close, it hurts more,” Tejaswin said. “Same thing happened three-four months later at my first decathlon event [of the season] in San Angelo. I had an explosive day one again. On the second day, I had breakthroughs in pole vault. Then in 1500m, all I needed was 4:40 to break the 8,000-point mark. I ran 4:51; I had never run that slow. The weather was tough (challenging), but that’s not an excuse. You train to handle any situation. I missed 8,000 by 53 points. I told myself ‘next time, no matter how far behind I am, I’ll cover it.’” A friendly taunt from his wife Siddhi Hiray motivated Tejaswin. In Ranchi, he targeted a time of 4:37 in 1500m to get to 8,000 points, but he managed to clock 4:29 to reach where he was longing for. Tejaswin understands his game well. “Everyone’s a different beast. Everyone has their own way. I made 8,000 in one way, someone else made it differently. Some have even scores across the board. Not many do 2.25m in high jump (in decathlon), and no one does 40m in javelin and still scores 8,000. It’s a weird balance. Everyone has their strengths and weaknesses. I play to mine: build a massive score on day one, and then do damage control on day two. As I improve in those events, I can score more.”

Double delight The 27-year-old, who recorded 2.25m during decathlon to breach the qualifying

mark in high jump, felt that he could improve in his pet discipline. He also made the cut in decathlon. “I think so. It has been a breakthrough year for me in high jump. In my first competition (in January), I did 2.26m. Then, it was 2.23m at Asian Indoors. Here (under pressure with lights going off and the competition stretching for three hours), I did 2.25m. My average is really good. Surprisingly, it’s better than my performance in the last Olympics year when I was fully prepared for high jump. That stings more.” So, does he wish to compete in both high jump and decathlon at the Glasgow Commonwealth Games? “I don’t know the full schedule. I know that decathlon is on July 30 and 31. High jump is also there, but I don’t know the order. Based on what I did here, I think I can do it. But if high jump is scheduled right after decathlon and I’m not running 400m, I might try.”

Support system’s role Tejaswin underlined the importance of a robust support system – which includes his wife, sister Avantika and strength and conditioning coach Wayne Lombard – and stressed that it helped him succeed in an arduous event like decathlon. “With 10 events, it’s a mental battle. You’re competing for two consecutive days, you’re emotionally up and down. Right now, I can sit and talk comfortably, but they know how much grief I’ve given them over the last two days. You need a support system that understands [your situation]. I’m not justifying being mean, but you need people who push you in the right direction, ensure that you in the right headspace and help with everything you need,” Tejaswin said. “I scored 8,000 points, but without those people – Wayne helping with nutrition between/after/before events, Siddhi yelling splits, my sister shouting ‘Chalo bhaiya’ – it wouldn’t have been possible. Those things distract you in crucial moments because you get caught in your own emotions. “At such times, you need people to distract you. You prepare all year, but if your mind takes over, it’s a problem. You want muscle memory to happen. They keep telling me that I have it in me. I just have to execute – make that 4.20m bar, run 4:29 to achieve the big goal.”

Looking at the bigger picture While enjoying his moment of glory in Ranchi, Tejaswin kept an eye on two athletes – sprinters Gurindervir Singh and Vishal T.K., who became the first Indians to go below 10.10 and 45 seconds in 100m and 400m respectively and made it a memorable day for athletics lovers. He looked at the bigger picture of India

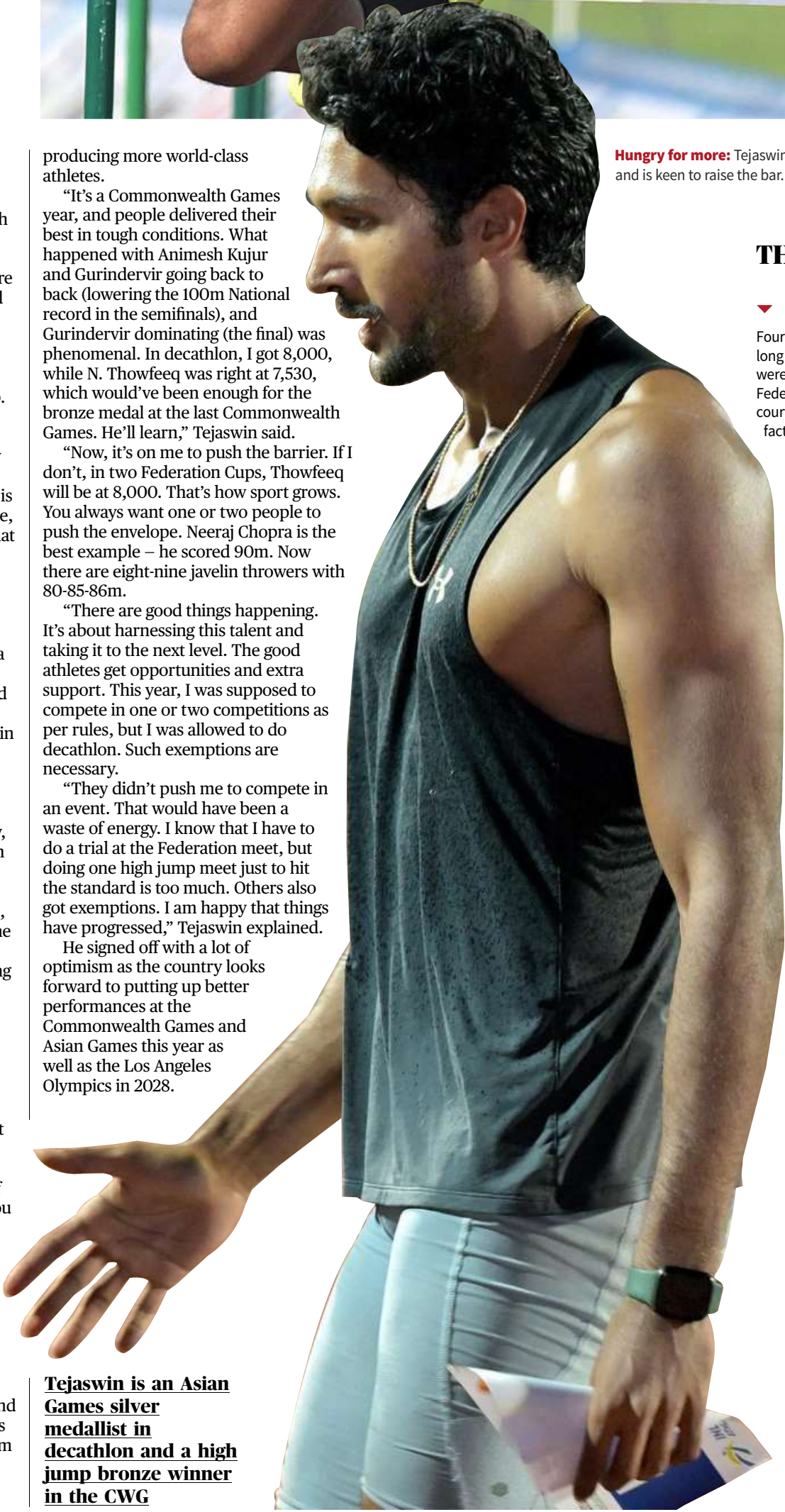
producing more world-class athletes. “It’s a Commonwealth Games year, and people delivered their best in tough conditions. What happened with Animesh Kujur and Gurindervir going back to back (lowering the 100m National record in the semifinals), and Gurindervir dominating (the final) was phenomenal. In decathlon, I got 8,000, while N. Thowfeeq was right at 7,530, which would’ve been enough for the bronze medal at the last Commonwealth Games. He’ll learn,” Tejaswin said. “Now, it’s on me to push the barrier. If I don’t, in two Federation Cups, Thowfeeq will be at 8,000. That’s how sport grows. You always want one or two people to push the envelope. Neeraj Chopra is the best example – he scored 90m. Now there are eight-nine javelin throwers with 80-85-86m. “There are good things happening. It’s about harnessing this talent and taking it to the next level. The good athletes get opportunities and extra support. This year, I was supposed to compete in one or two competitions as per rules, but I was allowed to do decathlon. Such exemptions are necessary. “They didn’t push me to compete in an event. That would have been a waste of energy. I know that I have to do a trial at the Federation meet, but doing one high jump meet just to hit the standard is too much. Others also got exemptions. I am happy that things have progressed,” Tejaswin explained. He signed off with a lot of optimism as the country looks forward to putting up better performances at the Commonwealth Games and Asian Games this year as well as the Los Angeles Olympics in 2028.

Tejaswin is an Asian Games silver medallist in decathlon and a high jump bronze winner in the CWG

Hungry for more: Tejaswin doesn’t want to rest on his laurels and is keen to raise the bar. RITU RAJ KONWAR

THE GIST

- Four personal bests (in 100m, long jump, 400m and 1500m) were achieved at the Federation meet in Ranchi, courtesy a combination of factors
- The 27-year-old recorded 2.25m during decathlon to breach the qualifying mark in high jump. He also made the cut in decathlon
- While enjoying his moment of glory, Tejaswin was all praise for sprinters Gurindervir and Vishal



Webb telescope captures weather on exoplanet 700 lightyears away

As state-of-the-art instruments like the Extremely Large Telescope, which Europe is currently building in northern Chile, become operational, astronomers could discover many exoplanet nurseries around distant stars, increasing manifold the possibility of finding more extra-solar earth-like planets and, who knows, even a true earth twin

Prakash Chandra
KOCHI

“Cloudy with a chance of rain” – imagine astronomers turning into meteorologists and issuing weather reports like this, but for alien planets.

According to a new study published in *Science* on May 21, scientists were able to use the NASA James Webb Space Telescope (JWST) to peer closely at an exoplanet nearly 700 lightyears away, and deciphered the weather patterns on it.

Named WASP-94A b, this exoplanet is almost twice as large as Jupiter but with only half the mass. It orbits very close to its parent star – so close that it takes just four days to complete a whole revolution.

Extreme worlds

Gas giants like WASP-94A b with scorching atmospheric temperatures are called ‘hot Jupiters’ and have their orbits tidally locked, meaning their rotation is synchronised with their revolution. As a result, the same side of the planet always faces the host star, much like the moon’s tidally locked orbit keeps one side always facing the earth.

WASP-94A b’s dayside is thus a sweltering desert with temperatures hot enough to melt rock while its nightside is perennially dark and frozen as temperatures dip to nearly absolute zero.

Astronomers have always been intrigued by the bizarre weather patterns on the 6,000 or so exoplanets they have found so far. But in the absence of a sufficiently powerful telescope, they have had no way to study these far-flung bodies.

NASA’s launch of the James Webb Space Telescope (JWST) in December 2021 was the gamechanger. The unprecedented sensitivity of its instruments – which allow the telescope to discern the details on a small coin from a distance of 50 km – has helped scientists study exoplanets’ atmospheres like never before. Many of these worlds have turned out to be rocky; some are even almost earth-like. But on some other exoplanets, scientists have found extreme temperatures and pressures producing rain of molten metal and vaporised rock. Still others have downpours of molten glass pushed by supersonic winds. Some gaseous exoplanets even have crystallised carbon raining down as diamonds.

‘A world far beyond’

Hot Jupiters though are the most studied exoplanets. The latest JWST discovery has found that WASP-94A b in particular has a dynamic weather system: its mornings are blanketed in clouds of magnesium



An artistic rendering of WASP-94A b, a gas giant around 700 lightyears away. On this exoplanet, clouds build as air flows over the night side of the planet, reaching a large swell by daybreak. They dissipate on the dayside, leaving clear skies in the early evening. HANNAH ROBBINS/JOHNS HOPKINS UNIVERSITY

silicate, iron, and magnesium sulphide while the evenings sport clear skies.

“The clouds appear to form on the cooler night side of the planet, sweep across the globe with extremely fast winds, and then disappear as they reach the hotter dayside,” Sagnick Mukherjee, lead author of the study and a postdoctoral fellow at Arizona State University, said. “This is a direct measurement of an extreme weather cycle unfolding on a world far beyond our Solar System.” Astronomers characterise the atmospheres of distant exoplanets using spectroscopy: light is split up into its various wavelengths, followed by measuring the intensity of each one. If the planet has an atmosphere, it will absorb some of the light. This will create a gap in the set of wavelengths arriving at the spectrometer. Since each molecule absorbs light of fixed wavelengths, it is easy to identify the compounds present in the atmosphere.

Slow transit

“To do that, we need some way to distinguish the planet’s light from the stars,” Bruce Macintosh, director of the University of California Observatories and professor of astronomy and astrophysics, said.

Prof. Macintosh, who was not part of the research team, said the astronomers used the transit method for their

discovery. “As the planet passes in front of the star, its atmosphere absorbs starlight. By studying exactly how that absorption changes with time, you can see the evidence that one side is cloudy and not the other. And by studying different wavelengths you can understand composition,” he explained.

According to University of Göttingen astrophysicist Lisa Nortmann, the researchers seemed to have studied the transit when the exoplanet passed slowly in front of its star.

“Therefore, at different times of observation, different parts of the planet are in front of the star. This effect was used in this study to ‘scan’ the planet’s atmosphere at different locations and this revealed that the atmospheric signal was different for morning and evening sides,” Dr. Nortmann, who was also not part of the study, said.

A major challenge in studying exoplanets, according to Dr. Mukherjee, is that clouds can obscure what their atmospheres are really made of.

“By separating the cloudy and clear sides of WASP-94A b, we show that earlier estimates of its composition can be strongly biased,” he said. “More broadly, the study demonstrates that understanding weather patterns on distant worlds is essential for learning how planets across a wide range of sizes (from earth-like rocky planets to

Neptune-like gas worlds and gas giants) form, evolve, and differ from planets in our own solar system.”

History of formation

Research like this could help astronomers learn about the planetary architectures of 4.6 billion years ago when the protoplanetary disk of gas and dust around the Sun started evolving into this Solar System. “The discs of material around a young star form planets. Different parts of that disc have different compositions – ice, gas, dust particles, etc.,” Prof. Macintosh said. By measuring the composition, you can tell something about the history of the formation (did it form out of solid material first or gas?) and even the location (did it form somewhere too hot for ice?). And then you can try and understand if the same process that made a big hot Jupiter like this could also make a smaller planet like the earth.”

As state-of-the-art instruments like the Extremely Large Telescope, which Europe is currently building in northern Chile, become operational, astronomers could discover many exoplanet nurseries around distant stars, increasing manifold the possibility of finding more extra-solar earth-like planets and, who knows, even a true earth twin. (Prakash Chandra is a science writer. prakashisat@gmail.com)

THE GIST

Astronomers have always been intrigued by the bizarre weather patterns on the 6,000 or so exoplanets they have found so far

But in the absence of a sufficiently powerful telescope, they have had no way to study these far-flung bodies

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BIG SHOT



Mummy homecoming: People of the Kolla indigenous community participate in a ceremony following the return of the so-called ‘Child of Chani’, an Inca-era child mummy found frozen in 1905 at nearly 5,900 m on a mountain, in Jujuy province, Argentina on May 28. The mummy had been in a Buenos Aires museum for around 120 years. REUTERS

WHAT IS IT?

Padma Barrage: another barrier

Vasudevan Mukunth

Bangladesh has approved a large river engineering project called the Padma barrage, on the Padma river, which is Bangladesh’s stretch of the Ganga, in Rajbari district. It is Bangladesh’s attempt to partially re-engineer the hydrology of its southwest region, which has become prone to drought after decades of reduced seasonal flows linked to the Farakka barrage upstream in India.

The barrage will be 2.1-km-long and have 78 spillway gates, undersluices, navigation locks, fish passages, and associated embankments. It will impound roughly 2.9 billion cubic metres of water and includes 113 MW of hydropower generation. According to Bangladesh, the project will affect roughly 37% of the country’s land area and irrigate around 2.88 million ha of farmland.

While the barrage’s supporters see a long-delayed national water security project in the Padma barrage, critics have said mega-barrages often underperform, alter sediment flows in unpredictable ways, and can create new ecological problems, such as water-logging and damage to fisheries. Some environmental groups have also criticised the speed of approval and called for greater public scrutiny.

As Mehebab Sahana at the University of Manchester and Bayes Ahmed at University College London have argued, the project highlights how South Asian countries are building more barriers to



Boats on the Padma river in 1860. PUBLIC DOMAIN

rivers rather than removing them. The regional turn towards unilateral river engineering is at odds with Europe and North America tearing down obsolete dams and culverts to restore rivers’ free flow. In 2025 alone, 21 European countries removed a record 603 barriers.



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Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Number of child labourers rescued in Bihar

122 The Bihar government has rescued 122 child labourers in the last 10 days and registered FIRs against 60 employers during a Statewide enforcement drive aimed at eliminating child labour, officials said on Sunday. Intensive inspections and raids were conducted at 222 locations across the State between May 20 and May 30. PTI

People arrested in France after PSG victory celebrations

780 French authorities announced that 780 people were arrested when overnight celebrations of Paris Saint-Germain's Champions League victory over Arsenal were marred by violent clashes, and a road accident that killed a young man. Thousands of people poured into the streets of Paris for the match and to revel in PSG's triumph. AFP

Proposed frozen assets to be released by U.S. to Iran as per the MOU

12 in \$ billion. Iranian state media reported on Saturday that a proposed memorandum of understanding with the United States included an agreement to release \$12 billion in frozen assets. The report cited an "unofficial" draft of the memorandum, and a similar item carried by state TV earlier this week was dismissed by the White House as a "fabrication". AFP

Effects of booms from meteor explosion over the United States

300 in tonnes. A meteor crashing toward earth exploded over the northeastern United States on Saturday, NASA said, setting off booms that echoed over the region with a blast equivalent to 300 tonnes of TNT. The fireball broke up over northeastern Massachusetts and southeastern New Hampshire at 2:06 p.m. (1806 GMT), the agency said. AFP

Fall in domestic air travel in India in April 2026

4.2 in per cent. The latest data from aviation watchdog DGCA showed that carriers flew more than 1.38 crore passengers in April, 3.47% lower than over 1.43 crore passengers carried in April last year. Over 1.35 lakh passengers were affected by flight delays and airlines shelled out little over ₹2.41 crore towards facilitation. PTI
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The apex court rings its own chain

The Supreme Court's reliance on *suo motu* cognisance has turned a once 'rare but highly visible' jurisdiction into a recurring instrument shaped by primetime attention and media reports; while it keeps 'ringing' its own chain through televised listings and supervision, the trial courts below it continue doing the work

LETTER & SPIRIT

V. Venkatesan

In 1605, on his accession, the Mughal Emperor Jahangir fastened a chain outside his palace. Any subject denied justice by his administration could pull the chain and reach the emperor directly. The chain was, in conception, a remedy against the bureaucracy. The Indian Supreme Court is now, in its *suo motu* cognisance of individual criminal cases, the bureaucracy itself, ringing its own version of the chain. Each televised listing is the sound of the apex court calling attention to itself.

Media and motive

The latest instance is the court's *suo motu* cognisance of Twisha Sharma's death, registered under the title 'In Re Alleged Institutional Bias and Procedural Discrepancies in the Unnatural Death of a Young Girl at Her Matrimonial Home'. The title prejudices its own inquiry. Institutional bias has not been judicially established at any level. The apex court's own office report, signed by the Assistant Registrar on May 23, records the basis of registration. The case was registered, the document says, 'based on media reports and other attending circumstances'. Two days later, the same bench appealed to the media to refrain from recording statements of witnesses. A court that acts on press reports while admonishing the journalists who filed them is, at the same moment, both consumer and critic of the same source.

The ground on which the apex court arrived was not vacant. A magistrate in Bhopal had remanded the husband, a practising advocate, to seven days of police custody. The Madhya Pradesh High Court had directed a second autopsy by an AIIMS Delhi team. The Bar Council of India had suspended the husband's licence. The State government had proposed transferring the investigation to the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) before the apex listing. The institutions whose bias the apex title alleges had been moving against the accused for nearly a fortnight.

Marc Galanter and Vasujith Ram put the central question to this reflex with care. Their study appears in A Qualified Hope (Cambridge University Press, 2019). Why does the response of the higher judiciary to executive or police failure take 'the form of these singular heroic interventions rather than promoting some institutional shake-up, some initiative to empower and equip courts lower in the judicial hierarchy'? Their diagnosis was unsparing. The reflex carries, they wrote, 'an echo of the disdain with which higher courts in India frequently treat the efforts of the lower judiciary'.

Easier path

Suo motu cognisance, in matters of this kind, is the easier of the two paths open to the apex court. The harder path is the slow, unspectacular work of reforming the judiciary it heads. The first requires only the bench's decision to list the matter. The second requires sustained cooperation: with the High Courts on case management and supervision under Article 235 (control over subordinate courts), with State governments on funding trial-court infrastructure, with the executive on judicial appointments, and with the National Judicial Academy on training. The asymmetry between the



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energies devoted to the two paths is what produces the diagnosis Galanter and Ram named.

Where the easier path is taken, the court chooses persuasion over compulsion. The apex bench has, in *Sahara India Real Estate Corporation v. SEBI* (2012), a five-judge Constitution Bench authority on media trial. Sahara permits a court to issue a postponement order against media publication. The test is a real and substantial risk of prejudice to the administration of justice. The order is available only where no less restrictive means will work. The doctrine is settled. In the Twisha matter, the bench had every occasion to invoke it. It chose instead to request the media not to record statements of potential witnesses. A request from the apex court carries moral weight. But it is not the legal instrument it has at hand for this very problem.

The post-2019 record is unkind to the pro-*suo-motu* case. In the R.G. Kar matter, the Supreme Court registered cognisance on August 18, 2024. Sanjay Roy had been arrested by the Kolkata Police eight days earlier. The Calcutta High Court had handed the probe to the CBI on August 13, 2024. The Sealdah trial court convicted Roy in January 2025 and sentenced him to life imprisonment. The trial judge did the work. Apex monitoring of CBI status reports did not.

Hathras is closer to the Bhopal facts and more instructive. The Lucknow bench of the Allahabad High Court registered the case *suo motu* in October 2020. The Supreme Court, after entertaining transfer petitions, handed monitoring back to the High Court within weeks. That earlier bench saw the architectural point: the High Court was already in motion, and the apex role was supervisory. In July 2024, following the Hathras Satsang stampede that claimed 121 lives, the court declined a PIL. The bench said that the High Court was

equipped to deal with the case. The same principle applies in Bhopal too.

Scarce attention

Lakhimpur Kheri sharpens the matter. The apex court took cognisance in October 2021 and, in April 2022, set aside the High Court's bail order for the main accused, Ashish Mishra. It then eased him back into liberty. Interim bail came in 2023. Regular bail followed in 2024. As of early 2026, the trial court had examined only 44 of 131 witnesses. In Manipur, the *suo motu* case over the viral video from July 2023 has yet to produce a conviction. Apex supervision has not been the route to faster justice.

A second observation runs alongside. In 2019, Galanter and Ram called *suo motu* 'rare but highly visible'. The first half of that description has lapsed. What was once a residual jurisdiction is now a recurring instrument. A trigger sequence has begun to repeat. Sustained primetime attention is followed by cognisance. The Solicitor General has now confirmed the sequence in open court. Appearing for the Union in the Twisha matter, he told the bench that 'it is also because of this media intervention that a lot of progress has happened'.

The numbers since the chapter, authored by Galanter and Ram, went to press confirm the rule. The Supreme Court Observer, working from the apex court's own Case Status records, counts 35 *suo motu* matters in the five years from 2020 to 2024.

The preceding fifteen years had seen only 31 in total. The annual figures, excluding contempt, were 10 in 2020, eight in 2021, one in 2022, four in 2023, and 12 in 2024. The trend continues. In 2025, the court's numbering reached 10 civil *suo motu* writs and three criminal matters. Nine of the 10 civil matters are publicly listed. By May 25 this year, the count already stood at four civil and four

criminal matters. Both totals exclude *suo motu* transfer and contempt, which exercise distinct constitutional powers. The criminal count, in particular, has risen sharply. Four months and three weeks have already exceeded the criminal count for all of 2025.

Judicial attention is a scarce resource. The National Crime Records Bureau recorded 6,450 dowry deaths in 2022, with convictions in only 11 to 17 per cent of cases. The court has the capacity to list one. The criterion of selection is, on the present record, temporal rather than legal. Galanter and Ram closed their chapter with a question. They asked whether *suo motu* was 'an instance of effective use of the scarce resource of judicial attention'. The seven years since they wrote have not produced an easier answer.

None of this is to deny the seriousness of the Twisha Sharma matter. The accused's mother is a retired judge. The husband is a lawyer. The family of the deceased has reason to fear local proximity. The constitutional response to that fear is independent investigation under judicial supervision, conducted promptly. The court, however, disposed of the matter on the first day after taking note of the "narrative" in the media that a fair investigation was being denied on account of the involvement of the judiciary.

The chain Jahangir hung was a remedy against an unaccountable bureaucracy. The apex court is now that bureaucracy. Each televised listing is the sound it makes to draw attention to a failure it has the power, and the constitutional duty, to repair. Until the harder of its two paths is walked with the energy now devoted to the easier one, the chain will keep ringing. The trial courts below it will keep doing the work.

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THE GIST

The ground on which the apex court arrived was not vacant, with the magistrate, the High Court, the Bar Council of India and the State government already acting in the Twisha Sharma case.

The harder path before the apex court is the slow, unspectacular work of reforming the judiciary through better case management, trial-court infrastructure, appointments and training.

Judicial attention is a scarce resource, but sustained primetime attention is increasingly followed by cognisance, raising questions about the use of that attention.

